

Agricultural transformation through skills upgrading of women and youth in Rwanda

2024 - 2029

Description of Action

May 2024 (revised August 2024)

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Acronyms

APEFE	Association pour la Promotion de l'Education et de la Formation à l'Etranger
CBT/CBA	Competency-Based Training /Competency-Based Assessment
CoVE	Centre of Vocational Excellence
EAV	Ecole Agricole et Vétérinaire
EF	Expertise France
EU	European Union
FMT	Farmer Master Trainer
FFS	Farmer Field School
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GMO	Gender Monitoring Office
ICT	Information and Communication Technologies
KfW	Kreditanstalt für Wiederaufbau
KOICA	Korea International Cooperation Agency
LLL	Lifelong Learning
LuxDev	Luxembourg Agency for Development Cooperation
MASA	Ministère de l'Agriculture et de la Souveraineté Alimentaire (France)
MEAL	Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning
MIFOTRA	Ministry of Public Service and Labour
MIGEPROF	Ministry of Gender and Family Promotion
MINAGRI	Ministry of Agriculture
MINEDUC	Ministry of Education
MoE	Ministry of Environment
MoU	Memorandum of Understanding
NESA	National Examination and School Inspection Authority
NGO	Non-Governmental Organisation
PSF	Private Sector Foundation
RDB	Rwanda Development Board
RAB	Rwanda Agriculture Board
REB	Rwanda Basic Education Board
RP	Rwanda Polytechnic
RPL	Recognition of Prior Learning
RTB	Rwanda TVET Board
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
SSC	Sector Skills Council
TSS	Technical Secondary School
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training
USAID	United States Agency for International Development

Project overview

Project title	Agricultural transformation through skills upgrading of women and youth in Rwanda
Location of implementation	Rwanda: Kigali, and the Northern and Western provinces
Team Europe Initiative	TEI on “Investing in Sustainable and Inclusive Agricultural Transformation”
Overall objective	Increase the sustainability, climate resilience and inclusivity of agriculture practices by strengthening the skills of women and youth, including persons with disability, in Rwanda.
Specific objectives	- Specific objective (outcome) 1: Improve access of women and youth (including persons with disability) to quality skills set and formal certification in agricultural practices, including climate-resilient agricultural practices. - Specific objective (outcome) 2: Enhance the effectiveness of mechanisms for the integration of women and youth (including persons with disability) on the agriculture labour market, with a focus on climate-resilient and sustainable farming.
Results/outputs	- O.1.1. Enhanced capacity of TVET institutions and the agriculture industry actors to address skills and employment needs, emphasising climate-resilient practices and the specific skill requirements of women and persons with disability. - O.1.2. Enhanced capacity of national Agri TVET Schools to provide standardised quality training in agriculture that is relevant to labour market needs and climate action, and is gender-responsive. - O.1.3. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to provide quality training and a conducive learning environment. - O.1.4. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to link with their ecosystem (research institutions, other TVET Schools, private sector, communities). - O.1.5. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to provide quality training and certification to farmers, especially women. - O.2.1: Enhanced capacity of Agri TVET Schools at national level to deliver standardised quality career guidance and market opportunity linkages. - O.2.2: Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to deliver quality career and transition to work guidance. - O.2.3: Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to support linkages to market/productive opportunities.
DAC codes	DAC code 1 – 11330- Vocational training DAC code 2 – 31181- Agricultural education/training
Total budget	Total project budget: EUR 16,200,000 Total amount of EU budget contribution: EUR 16,000,000 Co-financing by the French Ministry of Europe and Foreign Affairs: EUR 200,000

Project beneficiaries	Direct beneficiaries*: - 900 students, young girls and young men, persons with disability, from 03 supported Centres of Vocational Excellence in agriculture (Agri CoVEs); - 1,200 farmers, particularly women and including persons with disability, from the surrounding areas of the 03 supported Agri CoVEs - Staff from the 03 supported Agri CoVEs (about 24 management and administrative staff, 108 pedagogical staff). <i>*These targets assume that the three pre-identified TVET schools - EAV Bigogwe, TSS Kisaro, EAV Rushashi - will be supported, but the initial needs assessment at the project's start will confirm the final selection of schools and final targets.</i> Indirect beneficiaries: - Staff from institutions involved in TVET and agriculture (RTB, NESA, RAB...); - Students from other Agri TVET Schools; - Local authorities in the targeted districts; - Stakeholders in the agricultural sector, e.g., private actors, agricultural organisations, cooperatives...; - Rural communities in the surrounding areas of the supported Agri CoVEs.
Implementation modalities	Indirect/delegated management of EU funding by Expertise France
Start of the implementation	01 September 2024
Project duration	5 years (60 months)

1. Executive Summary

Rwanda has experienced remarkable economic growth in recent years, particularly in the agriculture sector. The latter has attracted significant investments to bolster government initiatives and strategies but also to address the challenges posed by changing climate patterns, with the goal of uplifting this sector that employs most of the Rwandan population, the majority of whom are women. Although growth and investments have materialised, the skills set of the current workforce has not necessarily adapted to current labour market opportunities and to the emerging climate conditions.

In the last decade, Rwanda has set a clear skills development vision that defines an optimised skills and employment ecosystem that foster long-term economic transformation with clear mandates for Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) governance bodies. However, its TVET system continues to be blamed for its low quality and mismatch to labour market needs, especially in the agriculture labour market, "flooded" with unskilled or low-skilled workforce, many women and youth.

This action will support Rwanda's aspiration to uplift skills and employment in agriculture, with a significant emphasis on gender roles and climate action, as pivotal elements of the nation's economic transformation. In line with Rwanda's National Strategy for Transformation-NST1 and Vision 2050, the present action will contribute to the sustainable transformation of the agricultural sector through

enhanced climate-resilient skills for women and youth, and reinforced TVET institutions able to better connect with the agriculture market.

The Overall Objective of this action is to increase the sustainability, climate resilience and inclusivity of agriculture practices by strengthening skills of women and youth, including persons with disability, in Rwanda. The action is built around two specific objectives:

1. Improve access of women and youth to quality skills set and formal certification in agricultural practices, including climate-resilient agricultural practices and including persons with disabilities.
2. Enhance the effectiveness of mechanisms for integration of women and youth on the agriculture labour market, with a focus on climate-resilient and sustainable farming, and including persons with disabilities.

The action will contribute to the Government of Rwanda's Vision 2050 goal to reduce the unemployment rate from 15.2% in 2019 to 7% in 2035 (with an increased ratio of male to female in labour for participation from 1.8:1 in 2019 to 1.5:1 in 2035) and to increase the number of students enrolled in TVET as a proportion of total students in Basic Education from 33.6% in 2019 to 60% in 2035.¹

This action will build on lessons learned from Expertise France's experience in successfully leading on technical assistance in TVET and market integration of women and youth. It will be delivered through a Team Europe approach with financing from the European Union (EU) and the French Ministry for Europe and Foreign Affairs, in close collaboration with a parallel project implemented by LuxDev and financed by the Luxembourg Ministry of Foreign Affairs - thus further positioning the EU and its member states as important funders of the TVET and agriculture sectors in Rwanda.

This action is a building block of the Team Europe Initiative on "Investing in Sustainable and Inclusive Agricultural Transformation" by integrating essential skills adaptation support, emphasising aid to infrastructure and value chains within the agriculture sector. This approach aligns with the TVET focal sector of the Rwanda Multi-Annual Indicative Programme (MIP), which aims to address the primary challenges in the TVET sector: enhancing the quality of education, including school management and curricula; and aligning learning outcomes with the demands of the private sector. Additionally, it aligns with the agriculture MIP focal sector and, more specifically, the ongoing EUR 52 million budget sector reform performance contract on Transformational Climate-Smart and Inclusive Agriculture (AAP 2021).

Finally, this action contributes to the roll out of the Global Gateway Strategy², and EU-Africa Global Gateway Investment Package, investing in education and training, which underlines the importance of expanding skills development opportunities, to meet emerging needs for Africa's economic and social transformation by 2030. The intervention will also contribute to the implementation of the EU's Gender Action Plan III³. The action will contribute to the Sustainable Development Goal 4 (Quality Education), SDG 8 (Decent work and economic growth), SDG 5 (Gender Equality), SDG 13 (Climate action), SDG 1 (No poverty) and SDG 2 (Zero Hunger).

2. Context, problem statement and relevance of the action

a. Context

The Rwandan economy is dominated by agriculture, a strategic sector contributing to 25% of the country's total GDP in 2022.⁴ The government acknowledged the importance of the agricultural sector to achieve the ambitious objectives of employment creation, economic transformation, green and private sector-led growth. A dedicated strategy for the agriculture sector, the *National Agricultural Policy*, has been adopted and operationalised through the *4th Strategic Plan for Agriculture Transformation 2018-*

¹ Vision 2050

² JOIN (2021)30 final, Joint Communication to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee, the Committee of the Regions and the European Investment Bank - The Global Gateway

³ JOIN (2020)17 final, Joint Communication to the European Parliament and the Council, EU Gender Action Plan (GAP) III – An ambitious agenda for gender equality and women's empowerment in EU external action

⁴ NISR, GDP National Accounts 2012, 2017, 2022 - mentioned in ETF report on Employment and Skills in Agriculture (2023).

2024 to support the development of the sector. Furthermore, Rwanda has led extensive Food System Dialogues and has committed to transform its food systems to ensure that all Rwandans have access to affordable healthy and nutritious food by leveraging modern technology and upgraded agriculture infrastructure to reduce food losses, and food waste, and green nature. However, the sector's growth has slowed down in the last years, from +5% between 2012 and 2017 to 2% between 2017 and 2022.

Moreover "Rwanda is increasingly experiencing the impacts of climate change. Rainfall has become increasingly intense and the variability is predicted to increase by 5% to 10% (Government of Rwanda, 2018a). Changes in temperature and precipitation and their distributions are the key drivers of climate and weather-related disasters that negatively affect Rwandans and the country's economy, including through droughts, floods, and landslides which results in damage to infrastructure, loss of lives and property (including crops) and contribute to soil erosion and water pollution. Rwanda is highly reliant on rain-fed agriculture both for rural livelihoods and exports of tea and coffee, in addition to depending on hydropower for half of its electricity generation. The country's ongoing economic growth is therefore highly threatened by climate change".⁵

The agricultural sector is particularly vulnerable to climate change. Strengthening the sector's climate resilience appears to be a key economic factor for the future development of the sector and the country. Rwanda, who has the ambition of being an African leader in the fight against climate change, largely addresses agriculture in its Nationally Determined Contribution⁶ on climate change.

The predominant value chains in Rwanda's GDP contribution are tea and coffee, while other, more labour-intensive and nutritious value chains such as horticulture only represent a small contribution. Promising value chains for economic development include agro-processing, as well as aquaculture and horticulture. Formal businesses in agriculture, forestry and fishing only represented 0.2% of the overall number of businesses for all economic sectors in 2020, while manufacturing (which includes food processing) accounted for 7.2%.⁷ The overwhelming majority of these businesses are private sector-owned (95.6%), cooperatives owning 1.4% of businesses and the public sector 1%.

The sector is further characterised by a very high informality. It is estimated that over 96% business-oriented enterprises of the sector were operating informally as of 2020. Practices are still predominantly traditional subsistence agriculture, with low productivity and very limited use of modern equipment and methods (0.1% of farmers), use of fertilisers or pesticides (respectively 37% and 11%), as well as irrigation techniques (9%), inducing a high dependence on rainfall. In addition, 77% of farmers operate on land smaller than 0.5 hectares.⁸

Despite low productivity, small producers contribute to around 75% of the total agricultural production. By 2031, if Rwanda continues its agricultural transformation trajectory, opportunities in value chain development, specialised farming, agri-preneurship, agri-tech, and green jobs will emerge. These sectors, currently with minimal engagement in the labour market, present potential for women and youth. The agriculture sector mobilises 68% of the total working population (estimated at 7.4 million in 2022), with 77% of them being female, and a majority of seniors (65+ yo, men and women). The predominant education level of people working in the agriculture sector is a primary school level (65% of farmers), 14% of them completed secondary school, while 20% didn't receive any education.⁹

Rwanda set a target of 60% of 9th grade graduates choosing TVET orientation by 2024 and is investing significant means to expand the TVET schools' network and increase their attractiveness. However, TVET remains a secondary option and is often blamed for not supplying the appropriate skills to meet labour market demands, especially in agriculture. Agriculture further suffers from a negative image among youth when it comes to choosing a training/career. As of 2023, 10% of all secondary TVET students were enrolled in agriculture- and food processing-related trades (i.e., 10,073 students in

⁵ Extract from the Updated Nationally Determined Contribution, Republic of Rwanda, May 2020

⁶ Updated Nationally Determined Contribution, Republic of Rwanda, May 2020. NDC are the commitment made by countries in the framework of the Paris Agreement.

⁷ NISR, Rwanda Establishment Census (REC), 2020 - mentioned in the ETF report on Employment and Skills in Agriculture (2023).

⁸ NISR Rwanda Agricultural Survey 2020 - mentioned in the ETF report on Employment and Skills in Agriculture (2023).

⁹ Ibid

secondary TVET, of which 51.2% were female).¹⁰ 4 out of 8 Integrated Polytechnic Regional Colleges (IPRC) and 40 secondary TVET schools (out of 451) offer agriculture-related trades. According to a recent tracer study of graduates done in 2022, the lowest employment rate of graduates was observed among graduates from agriculture, forestry, and fishery trades. It is estimated that up to 3,000 youth graduate from agriculture-related trades each year, which is insufficient to fill the gap of the active working force leaving the sector each year, estimated at around 50,000 (due to retirement, reorientation, etc.). A number of targeted interventions will be needed to counter this trend.

To respond to these challenges, the Government of Rwanda, through its *Vision 2050* and the *National Strategy for Transformation 1 (NST1) 2017-2024 and NST2 (under development)*, established a policy framework to prioritise skills development as key enabler for the country's social and economic development. It aims at creating 1,500,000 new jobs by 2024 across sectors through specific actions. The role of women in the leadership of agricultural cooperatives and companies will be promoted, as well as their inclusion as beneficiaries of rural services.¹¹

Rwanda, as one of regional and global leaders in gender equality and women's economic empowerment, also adopted a strong policy framework in this regard, centred on the revised *National Gender Policy 2021*. Yet, although women represent the majority of agriculture workers, studies show that they have limited access to finance and land, and benefit less from agriculture extension services (39% of women vs. 52% of men in 2019).¹² In 2020, the Ministry of Agriculture (MINAGRI) launched a study on Women's Empowerment in Agriculture, to monitor gender-specific data and better capture the persisting gaps and needs of female workers in the sector, but challenges remain to improve the access to and conditions of training and employment for women in the agriculture sector.

The EU and its Member States' actions in Rwanda are in support of the roll out of the EU Global Gateway strategy and the external dimension of the EU Green Deal, and are aligned with the country's *National Strategy for Transformation* and *Vision 2050*. In line with the Entrepreneurship Development Policy and with a view to promote an inclusive ecosystem, EU support focuses on creating more opportunities for the underserved youth, female entrepreneurs and members of vulnerable groups to start and grow their own businesses. The focus is on supporting economic transformation and a green transition, which in turn also requires fostering a more equitable and cohesive society as reflected in the multi-annual indicative priorities of education, green deal and governance.

In particular, the EU and Team Europe members will distinguish themselves from other partners in Rwanda by focussing on three Flagships (Team Europe Initiatives) in support of the roll out of the Global Gateway strategy, one of which is on sustainable and inclusive agricultural transformation.

b. Problem statement and relevance of the action

At sector level, the poor productivity of the agriculture sector is a major challenge and presents a high risk for the country's food security (with 49% of people living below the international poverty line in 2021)¹³, despite the country's valuable natural resources and high potential for agricultural production. Indeed, the sector is still largely characterised by informal work, smallholder farmers and subsistence agriculture, particularly for women. The country faces a variety of challenges, putting additional pressure on the sector: the country's population is foreseen to increase from 13.2 million inhabitants in 2023 to up to 23 million in 2050¹⁴, posing new issues in terms of feeding the population with nutritious food. Rwanda is also exposed to the consequences of climate change, particularly land degradation and soil erosion (aggravated by the country's geography). To respond to these challenges, intensification of agriculture appears necessary while doing so sustainably through an improved use and preservation of the country's natural resources. Agricultural productivity is still low as the majority of farmers practice subsistence farming on small, hilly plots. In part due to this, household food insecurity and under-

¹⁰ ETF report on Employment and Skills in Agriculture (2023).

¹¹ MIP Rwanda

¹² DfID, 2020.

¹³ Macro-Poverty Outlook (MPO) for Rwanda, World Bank (2022).

¹⁴ NISR (2022), 5th Rwanda Population and Housing Census.

nutrition remain a challenge. Over a third of the Rwandan population experiences food insecurity. According to the 2019-20 Demographic Health Survey report, nationally, 33 % of children under 5 years are stunted, 8 % suffer from underweight and 1 % from acute malnutrition (wasting). Stunting in childhood increases the risk of poor education outcomes and reduced earning capacity in adulthood.

However, despite government efforts and development partners' initiatives over the years to promote access and quality TVET in all sectors and particularly in agriculture, Rwanda's workforce population still lacks adequate technical and entrepreneurial competencies to reach the country's objectives. This lack of skills is both qualitative (insufficient level of qualification) and quantitative (not enough TVET graduates in agriculture-related trades), and hinders the further development of the agriculture sector. Further analysis identifies two major issues of TVET in the agriculture sector, which, at the same time, represent entry points for supporting measures to be implemented through this Action:

i. **Overall low quality of agriculture TVET schools which do not respond to the Rwanda labour market needs.**

The main shortcomings include:

- Mismatch between provided skills and needs of the private sector: current TVET programmes in agriculture are not private sector-led and involvement of the private sector in elaboration/adaptation of curricula, in training is limited. This because the private sector in agriculture is overwhelmingly informal and dominated by micro/small enterprises which do not have capacity to engage with TVET actors. As a result, the developed TVET programmes are predominantly theoretical, with limited input from professionals. On the other hand, the training offer typically consists of long-term training programmes, while there is significant demand for short courses, tailored for an adult audience, currently active in the agricultural sector, seeking to enhance their skills;
- Insufficient modern infrastructure and equipment: TVET schools often lack basic modern equipment and infrastructure, and training spaces (workshops, classrooms, etc.) are also often inadequate/limited. There is a need to create a more conducive, gender- and disability-inclusive learning environment at Agri TVET schools that is aligned with the realities of the agriculture labour market and can equip students with the relevant skills;
- Lack of linkages between Agri TVET schools and their surrounding environment, particularly with the private sector, research actors, neighbouring communities, as well as with other Agri TVET schools;
- Low/inadequate level of practical skills and industrial exposure of TVET trainers: additionally, TVET trainers themselves often have limited/no practical experience and are not sufficiently exposed to evolutions and needs of the private sector, with limited opportunities to develop their competencies;
- Lack of disability-disaggregated data, which impedes evidence-based strategies to promote disability inclusion by addressing the idiosyncratic challenges of persons with disability¹⁵.

ii. **Limited facilitation mechanisms supporting women and TVET graduates on the agriculture labour market in Rwanda.**

Some of the key shortcomings are as follows:

- Women's participation in salaried employment is limited due to no/limited access to systems and networks which they can leverage for job opportunities. Although the rate of women's participation in the agriculture sector is higher than men's, this doesn't reflect in their representation on the labour market. The percentage of women in unstable job roles, such as self-employment or as

¹⁵ Situation Analysis of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Rwanda UNPRPD Country Report 2021.

contributing family workers, is considerably higher than that of men. Due to societal constraints, women might not have as extensive or influential networks in the agricultural sector. Without networks and with difficult access to sources of information, women cannot easily access internship or job opportunities. Creating platforms and mechanisms, allowing mentorship and networking between women is essential to their integration on the labour market;

- Lack of industry attachment of TVET students: with a narrow (formal) private sector, opportunities for industry attachment as foreseen in Rwanda's Workplace Learning Policy are limited for TVET students, resulting in low industry exposure and limited practical training. Agriculture TVET schools also lack the capacity and resources for providing linkages to the existing opportunities. Internship and mentorship activities are often informal and organised by the students themselves;
- Inadequate/limited career and transition-to-work guidance at TVET schools, which generally only provide training to the detriment of the two other components of the chain "orientation – training – market integration" due to lack of dedicated resources and trained staff;
- Low consideration for the agriculture sector: many youths and/or their parents do not choose an education in the agriculture sector as first choice as the sector suffers from a bad reputation across generations and one that is culturally deeply-rooted. Engineering or a career in the public sector are still preferred in order to "succeed" in life;
- No formal Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) in the agriculture sector, which limits capacity development and professional integration on the labour market: many farmers, especially women, have gained a wealth of knowledge and skills through years of hands-on experience. By formally recognising the skills women already possess, RPL can enhance their self-confidence and assertiveness, expertise in climate-resilient farming, empowering them to take on more prominent roles in their communities and better access to job opportunities;
- Women's and youth's access to finance is limited: initiatives tackling women's and youth's access to finance in the agriculture sector exist, yet barriers persist. Limited financial literacy is perceived as high risk, exacerbated by climate uncertainties and inadequate collateral for women, restricting their capacity to invest in climate-resilient agricultural ventures.

iii. **Low consideration for climate change in the training offer**

The escalating impact of climate change on agriculture highlights the crucial need for developing training in climate smart and resilient agriculture, and for integrating "green" skills into the agricultural TVET programmes. However, current curricula scarcely address these skills. Climate change affects crop yields, changes rain patterns, and increases the frequency of extreme weather events, all of which directly influences agricultural practices and disproportionately affects women, exacerbating their vulnerabilities. Mastering climate-smart agricultural techniques, water-conservation practices, and sustainable farming is essential for the new generation of farmers. Yet, these green skills, which include technical competencies, interdisciplinary knowledge, and a strong ethical foundation towards sustainability, are often overlooked.

To address these shortcomings, the Rwandan authorities' have committed to gradually transform 30 TVET schools, including 10 in agriculture, into **Centres of Vocational Excellence (CoVEs)**. This transformation into CoVEs would involve improving the infrastructure and equipment available within the CoVEs, enhancing the quality of the training provided, and offering training tailored to the needs of individuals already in the workforce, including the integration of digital tools. Additionally, the CoVEs are expected to engage more closely with their surroundings by incorporating the needs expressed by the private sector into their training programmes, establishing stronger ties with agricultural private enterprises, fostering relationships and conducting joint activities with applied research, surrounding communities, and other agricultural TVET institutions. The CoVEs would serve as models and resource hubs for their ecosystem and other TVET schools. Moreover, CoVEs should not restrict their activities

to "training" but should integrate the entire "orientation-training-market integration" chain by developing school and career guidance services and offering support tools to facilitate employment and self-employment opportunities, including mechanisms like cooperative formation and access to agricultural financing. The aim of this Action is to create a new paradigm for Agri TVET Schools by supporting their transition into Agri CoVEs capable of meeting the demand for skilled human resources in the agricultural labour market and addressing Rwanda's agricultural development challenges.

3. Design of the Action

a. Objectives of the project

The Overall Objective (impact) of this Action is to contribute to increased sustainability, climate resilience and inclusivity of agriculture practices by strengthening skills of women and youth including persons with disability, in Rwanda.

The Specific Objectives (outcomes) of this Action are to:

- Specific Objective 1: Improve access of women and youth (including persons with disability) to quality skills set and formal certification in agricultural practices, including climate-resilient agricultural practices.
- Specific Objective 2: Enhance the effectiveness of mechanisms for the integration of women and youth (including persons with disability) on the agriculture labour market, with a focus on climate-resilient and sustainable farming.

This Action will support Rwanda's aspiration to uplift skills and employment, with a significant emphasis on gender roles and climate action in the agriculture sector, as pivotal elements of the nation's economic transformation. It will partner with the Rwanda TVET Board (RTB), the national agency for vocational education, to assist in the design and realisation of the CoVE strategy in agriculture. Three TVET schools in the Western and Northern Provinces have at this stage been pre-identified to receive support as they transition to Agriculture CoVEs; an initial needs assessment at the project's start will confirm the final selection of schools to be supported through this project.

b. Expected results and main activities

The project's expected results (outputs) and associated activities are divided in two levels: at national level and at targeted Agri CoVE level. Those at national level are intended to support national institutions in developing and implementing their CoVE strategy and benefit all future Agri CoVEs at large. They are complemented by outputs and activities at targeted Agri CoVE level for the pilot of interventions, and the collected lessons learned will inform future national roll-outs. This division also ensures a smooth collaboration with LuxDev, implementing a parallel project on TVET in agriculture, and facilitates complementarity and synergies between the two projects.

The Expected results (outputs) of this action, along with the main associated activities, are:

Outputs contributing to Specific Objective 1:

The set of activities under output 1.1 and 1.2 are meant to benefit and apply to institutions and Agri TVET Schools at the national level, while the activities under the following outputs 1.3, 1.4 and 1.5 will be piloted with the Agri CoVEs targeted in this project.

- 1.1. **Enhanced capacity of TVET institutions and the agriculture industry actors to address skills and employment needs, emphasising climate-resilient practices and the specific skill requirements of women and persons with disability.**

- A.1.1.1. Support the **development of employment and skills surveys**, to capture the evolving roles of women in agriculture and to emphasise climate action strategies, and in the identification of missing skills and needed ones on the agriculture labour market, with a specific focus on green skills and skills tailored for women's and persons with disability empowerment particularly for the lower-qualified.

Description: The Sector Skills Council in Agriculture (SSC Agri, formerly led by Rwanda Development Board, now by MIFOTRA) is responsible for facilitating the matching between skills and labour market needs in agriculture. However, the effective operations of the SSC Agri have been hindered by institutional weaknesses. EF's technical assistance will provide methodological and operational support to the SSC Agri, including exploring how to set up a secretariat and support its management. Support will also be provided through short-term expertise for the development of employment and skills surveys, ensuring that green, resilient skills and skills tailored to women and persons with disability (particularly for the lower-qualified) are integrated. The surveys will be an opportunity to review the political commitments made by the Government of Rwanda towards resilient and climate smart agriculture and their potential impacts in terms of skills and jobs evolution in the sector. The compliance and/or ambition of the agriculture industry towards the national climate change goals will also have to be taken into account, as a factor influencing the jobs-demand.

The study will be updated every two years to incorporate the latest developments related to skills demands by the agricultural private sector, and studies will be conducted in years 1, 3, and 5.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert, the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, and the Gender Expert;
- Technical assistance through national expertise in disability and inclusion for the integration into the surveys of the needs of persons with disabilities (contractual service).

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- A.1.1.2. Support the coordination of an **exchange forum between TVET institutions and the agriculture industry actors** on skills and employment needs, with a focus on the specific needs of women, youth and persons with disability, and climate-resilient practices.

Description: The results of the skills surveys conducted by SSC Agri, with EF's technical assistance, will be presented at a forum for TVET institutions and the agriculture industry actors. Occupational standards will be discussed and developed together: these will provide a clear description of the skills and competencies required for a specific job in agriculture, based on the survey results and to be used by TVET providers. SSC Agri will facilitate the forum with support from the project for its organisation and logistics. The forums will be held sequentially following the completion of the surveys, with three forums scheduled for years 1, 3, and 5.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the Gender Expert;
- Technical assistance through national expertise in disability and inclusion (contractual service).

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- A.1.1.3. Provide **capacity-building/raise awareness** among TVET institutions and the agriculture industry actors on **the specific needs of women, youth, and persons with disability**.

Description: To raise awareness among TVET institutions (RTB, NESA, RP, REB...) and the agriculture industry actors (PSF...) about the specific needs of women, youth, and persons with disability, awareness days will be organised for their benefit. This can include learning from successful initiatives in agriculture specifically designed for women, youth and persons with disability. To reach a wide audience and address various themes related to these aspects, awareness days will be organised in year 1 and repeated in years 3 and 5.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team: TVET Expert, Gender Expert;
- Technical assistance for awareness days provided by National Expert Inclusion (contractual service).

○ **1.2. Enhanced capacity of national Agri TVET Schools to provide standardised quality training in agriculture that is relevant to labour market needs and climate action, and is gender-responsive.**

- A.1.2.1. Develop a **governance model** for Agri CoVEs, including mechanisms to ensure their financial sustainability.

Description: To develop a governance model for Agri CoVEs, international expertise will be sought to propose one or several governance models adapted to the context of Rwanda. The proposals will be presented during a workshop which will lead to the validation of a model intended to be piloted among the supported Agri CoVEs.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through international expertise, suggestively by leveraging EF's convention with the French Ministry for Agriculture and Food Security (MASA);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert.

- A.1.2.2. Develop an **accreditation framework for Agri CoVEs**, to assess the excellency level of existing centres in agriculture, adapting the existing *International Self-Assessment Tool for Centres of Vocational Excellence* and incorporating criteria related to climate action, gender and inclusion.

Description: The transition from Agri TVET Schools to Agri CoVEs will be supported by a reference framework that clearly defines what a CoVE is, its characteristics, and the requirements it must meet. Considering NESA's expertise in quality approach for training institutions, the agency will be a key partner in this activity, with technical assistance from the EF team and national expertise in accreditation of training institutions and for inclusion aspects. The proposed accreditation framework will be presented and validated during a workshop. Technical assistance provided by the EF team will support the development of the framework regarding gender aspects and in terms of how to address climate change as an Agri CoVEs.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in accreditation of training institutions (contractual service);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, and led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the Gender Expert;
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in disability and inclusion (contractual service).
- Close collaboration with NESA is envisaged to build on their expertise, for their buy-in and for the relevance of the intervention.

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- A.1.2.3. Develop **assessment guidelines** for Agri CoVEs incorporating criteria related to climate action, gender and inclusion.

Description: Once the accreditation framework has been validated, its implementation within the Agri CoVEs will require the development of an assessment guideline, including criteria related to the integration of climate change, gender and inclusion in curricula and the Centres strategies. The guidelines will allow Agri TVET Schools to assess their compliance with the requirements defined for achieving the Agri CoVE status. The development of the guidelines will build on NESAs' expertise and be led by national expert(s) in assessing training institutions, with technical assistance from the EF team and national expertise on disability and inclusion. The proposed assessment guidelines be presented and validated during a workshop.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in the assessment of training institutions (contractual service);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, and led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the Gender Expert;
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in disability and inclusion (contractual service).

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- A.1.2.4. **Develop and/or review curricula** in the trades i) agriculture, ii) animal health and iii) food processing, following the CBT/CBA requirements and ensuring alignment with labour market needs and emerging/green competencies (including climate change resilience)

Description: based on the surveys on skills needs in the agricultural sector (A.1.1.1), the curricula will be developed/revised to align with the identified market needs. As of now, for the three trades considered (agriculture, animal health, and food processing), curricula are available for levels 3 and 4, and under development for level 5. Mainstreaming the impacts of climate change into the content developed for the curriculum will be crucial to adapt the sector. Where possible, the project will seek to promote high-value crops such as **avocados, macadamia nuts and passion fruits**, given their impact on employment. This task will be entrusted to national expert(s) in curricula development who will facilitate a set of workshops organised by trades, bringing together training programme developers, teachers, and professionals from the relevant fields. Awareness days will also be organised to raise awareness among TVET institutions and the agriculture industry actors about integration of climate strategies. EF will provide technical assistance for framing and coordinating the activities.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in curricula development and in the three trade subjects (agriculture, animal health, food processing) (contractual services);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, and led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert.

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- A.1.2.5. **Review curricula** in the trades i) agriculture, ii) animal health and iii) food processing to ensure they are **gender-responsive and inclusive**.

Description: Considering that curricula do not always incorporate gender and inclusivity dimensions, workshops will be conducted for each trade to include these dimensions in the revised training programmes. The workshops will be facilitated by Gender and Inclusion Experts, with participation from RTB and participants from the training programme development/revision working group, ensuring that these dimensions are included in all

training programmes developed in the future. The curricula developed (A.1.2.4) and made gender-responsive and inclusive (A.1.2.5) will be presented and validated during a workshop.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, and led by the Gender Expert, in collaboration with the TVET Expert;
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in disability and inclusion (contractual service).

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- A.1.2.6. Develop **modular short courses**, including on sustainable and circular economy, gender and nutrition.

Description: modular short courses will be developed in cross-cutting subjects that are essential for providing women and youth with a holistic knowledge in agriculture: sustainable and circular economy, gender and nutrition, but other themes could be identified following the needs surveys. The courses will be offered by Agri CoVEs and will be designed to target both students and farmers, especially women, from the neighbouring communities. Conscious of women's activities and responsibilities (agricultural, personal and family), the format of modular short courses has been chosen for more flexibility and easier access for women, and is also suitable as a complement to students' curricula. National expertise in curriculum development will be contracted for designing the courses and three-day workshops will bring together Experts from the relevant domains. A validation workshop with key stakeholders will be facilitated upon completion of the short courses.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in curricula development and in the different subjects (contractual services).
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Gender Expert;

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- A.1.2.7. Develop a **gender-responsive and inclusive trainers' guide** for the revised curricula.

Description: To support trainers in applying gender and inclusive approaches in their teaching, it is proposed to develop a gender-responsive and inclusive trainers' guide. The development of this guide would be entrusted to a national expert(s) in training of trainers, in collaboration with EF's Gender Expert and a national expert(s) in disability and inclusion, who will draft a guide to be presented, discussed and validated during a workshop involving partners and key stakeholders (such as RTB...).

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, and led by the Gender Expert, in collaboration with the TVET Expert;
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in training of trainers, and in disability and inclusion (contractual services).

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- A.1.2.8. Provide **capacity-building of staff in charge of developing training and evaluation frameworks**, following the CBT/CBA methodology and addressing the unique challenges/needs of women and persons with disability in the training environment.

Description: The development of training programmes and evaluation framework requires training/strengthening of CBT/CBA skills. To this end, 3-day capacity-building training sessions on CBT/CBA will be organised for the working groups of the different trades involved (programme developers from RTB, trainers, and professionals engaged in the

activity). These training sessions will particularly emphasise the needs of women and persons with disabilities. The training will be conducted by the technical assistance mobilised by EF with support from national expert(s) in disability and inclusion.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Gender Expert;
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in training of trainers, and in disability and inclusion (contractual services).

- A.1.2.9. Support the development of **Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) in agriculture**, taking into account the specific skills of women and needs of persons with disability.

Description: RPL allows farmers, often without formal education or training, to have their skills recognised. This recognition opens possibilities for engaging in more formal training, and for accessing services (financing, subsidies, etc.) and market opportunities. The mechanism already exists for other professions and is only just beginning in the agricultural sector (specifically for food processing). Firstly, the RPL framework in agriculture-related trades will be established; then, the evaluators will be trained in carrying it out. The first task would be entrusted to national expertise in RPL, which would establish a proposal for adapting the RPL framework to the agricultural sector. This proposal would then be reviewed by a national expert(s) in disability and inclusion, and finally, amended and validated in a workshop involving relevant stakeholders. For the second task, the evaluators responsible for its implementation will benefit from a 2-day training session, organised and facilitated by the national expert(s) in RPL. The EF team will provide technical support and coordinate the logistics of this training.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in RPL for framework development and training of evaluators, and in disability and inclusion (contractual services);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the Gender Expert;

- **1.3. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to provide quality training and a conducive learning environment.**

The set of activities under this output, as well as the following outputs 1.4 and 1.5, will be piloted specifically at the Agri CoVEs targeted in this project.

- A.1.3.1. Set up and build capacity of an **excellency committee** and the development of an **excellency action plan**, with dedicated initiatives and frameworks in place to support women's participation, representation, and advancement in agriculture, while also integrating climate-resilient and sustainable strategies.

Description: The implementation of the Agri CoVEs should be accompanied by a pursuit of excellence. This pursuit of excellence can only be achieved gradually by involving the existing strengths within the centres. Therefore, excellency committees will be established within each targeted Agri CoVE to annually establish an action plan aimed at advancing excellency within the centres. They should have a mandate to insure that climate resilient and gender responsive actions are mainstreamed into curricula as well as into the centres' overall strategies and action plans, as a factor of excellency. This excellency action plan will be based on the criteria defined within the CoVE accreditation framework (see A.1.2.2). National expertise will be contracted to support the excellency committees within each targeted Agri CoVE in the production of excellency action plans and training them in the "excellency" approach. NESAI will also be involved, especially in years 2 and 3 to capitalise

on the excellency initiatives implemented within each Agri CoVE. The EF team will provide technical support to both the NESAs team and targeted Agri CoVEs.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in quality assurance of training institutions (contractual service);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Gender Expert, the Resilient Agriculture Expert and CoVE Project Advisers.

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- A.1.3.2. Conduct a **needs assessment for infrastructure and equipment**, based on excellency requirements and with specific attention to environmental sustainability, gender and inclusion requirements.

Description: In order to achieve fully operational Agri CoVEs, it is necessary to equip them with the infrastructure and equipment that will provide students with an optimal learning environment and allow them to train with modern market-relevant equipment. Three TVET schools have been identified at this stage and an assessment of their needs will be conducted, based on a benchmarking analysis of practices and lessons from other countries with a CoVE strategy, which will inform the final number of schools to target for this project.

The needs assessment will include an environmental impact assessment, accompanied by recommendations for mitigation measures and sustainability. Environmental and social guidelines will be taken into considerations, specifically climate resilience such as thermal performance (in a context of rising temperatures), materials (and their origin), exposure to climate hazards (such as flood, etc.), and the minimum standards for gender-sensitive and inclusive infrastructure. This task will then lead to the contracting of necessary infrastructure and the procurement of equipment (see A.1.3.3).

EF, as the contracting authority, will contract for Infrastructure Project Management Assistance for intermittent support to plan and follow the progress of the needs assessment and infrastructure design that will be led by a contracted private operator. RTB will be responsible for all matters related to land property for this activity and A.1.3.3.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Deputy Project Manager for contracting and coordination of the Infrastructure Project Management Assistance, in collaboration with the TVET Expert, Gender Expert, Resilient Agriculture Expert and CoVE Project Advisers;
- Private contractor for Infrastructure Project Management Assistance;
- Private contractor for the needs assessment and architectural design;
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in disability and inclusion for the review and adaptation of the needs assessment (contractual service).

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- A.1.3.3. Contract for **infrastructure expansion and/or rehabilitation and equipment**, based on Agri CoVEs' needs and ensuring environmental and social sustainability, gender sensitivity and inclusion.

Description: Based on the needs assessment and benchmarking analysis (A.1.3.2.), the infrastructure expansion and/or rehabilitation will be carried out through a tender process according to the applicable public procurement procedures. Infrastructure Project Management Assistance will be contracted intermittently to support the EF project team in planning, contracting and following the infrastructure activities. Infrastructure Project

Management will be contracted for the coordination and supervision of the construction works and sites, led by a construction company.

The procurement of the equipment will also involve tender processes based on the nature of the equipment and the opportunity for national/regional and/or international procurement. National/regional procurement will be prioritised to the extent possible (e.g., quality, delivery time), for sustainability reasons. Consumables will also be provided to the targeted Agri CoVEs and will be purchased locally.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team led by the Deputy Project Manager for contracting and coordination of the Infrastructure Project Management Assistance, in collaboration with the TVET Expert, Gender Expert, Resilient Agriculture Expert and CoVE Project Advisers;
- Private contractor for Infrastructure Project Management Assistance;
- Private contractor for the Infrastructure Project Management;
- Private suppliers (national/region and/or international) for the supply of equipment and consumables in agriculture, animal health and food processing.

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- A.1.3.4. Provide **capacity-building to Agri CoVEs' management and administrative staff** on climate action and sustainability principles, and ensuring a gender-responsive and inclusive institution.

Description: The transition from Agri TVET Schools to Agri CoVEs will also require an improvement in school management and leadership practices for the centre's management and administrative teams, as well as the integration of themes that have been relatively overlooked so far, notably climate action and sustainable principles, gender and inclusion. An 8-day training session will be organised to enhance the skills of the targeted Agri CoVE management and administrative teams (8 persons/CoVE). The organisation and logistics will be handled by the EF project team.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert (2-day training session on climate), the Gender Expert (1-day training session on gender) and the CoVE Project Advisors for direct support to the CoVE management and admin teams;
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in school management (4-day training session) and in disability and inclusion (2-day training session) (contractual services).

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- A.1.3.5. Provide **capacity-building for Agri CoVEs' teaching staff** to equip them with skills and knowledge to address climate-related challenges in agriculture, and to recognise and address the unique challenges women and persons with disabilities face in agriculture.

Description: The teaching staff from the Agri TVET Schools, expected to evolve into Agri CoVEs, have limited knowledge in topics related to climate, gender and inclusion. A 5-day training session will therefore be organised to enhance the skills of the supported Agri CoVE teaching staff in these topics. Considering the number of trainers to be trained, each Agri CoVE will benefit from 2 training sessions, each session bringing together 18 teachers. The organisation and logistics will be handled by the EF project team.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert (2-day training session on climate), the Gender Expert (2-day training session on gender) and the CoVE Project Advisors for direct support to the CoVE teaching teams;

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in disability and inclusion (1-day training session) (contractual service).

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- A.1.3.6. Support the **on-the-job training of Agri CoVEs' teaching staff** through training of trainers in companies, to acquire workplace relevant skills that not only meet current industry standards but also address the pressing challenges posed by climate change.

Description: The trainers from the Agri TVET Schools may lack practical and up-to-date skills to deliver training. It is envisaged to provide per diem to 10 staff per targeted Agri CoVE, to cover the costs (accommodation, transportation, meal expenses) associated with undertaking a 10-day on-the-job training in a company. The choice of on-the-job training location should be related to the subjects taught by the trainer, with priority given to on-the-job training in companies that prioritise sustainable and climate-resilient practices. The choice of training will be suggested by the trainer and jointly approved by the school management and the EF team. The school will schedule the training to minimise disruption to academic activities. Upon completion of the training, the trained staff will submit a written report and a session for disseminating learnings will be facilitated.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert in collaboration the CoVE Project Advisors for facilitation of on-the-job trainings.

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- A.1.3.7. Set up and support the management of **a business-oriented production unit**, supporting targeted Agri CoVEs' financial sustainability and promoting sustainable and climate-smart practices.

Description: In accordance with the guidelines of the Rwandan authorities, production units should be established within Agri CoVEs to contribute to the schools' financial sustainability. The project will therefore develop business models for the production units, promoting climate resilience and sustainable resource management. This activity will be entrusted to international expertise, and the business models will be discussed and validated during a workshop. The EF team will provide support in carrying out this activity.

The implementation of the validated business model in targeted Agri CoVEs will be supported by the EF team through quarterly visits from the Experts and regular assistance from the CoVE Project Advisors. This support will ensure the proper implementation of the model, adaptation and the adoption of sustainable and climate-smart best practices.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through international expertise in developing business models for agricultural institutions, suggestively by leveraging EF's convention with the MASA.
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the CoVE Project Advisers.

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- A.1.3.8. Set up, equip and support the management of **a resource centre** with documentary, technological and pedagogical material.

Description: The resource centre is designed as a physical space where members of the CoVE's pedagogical team, as well as trainers from surrounding Agri TVET Schools, can access documentary resources, including digital resources and specific resources on climate change in agriculture, as well as didactic and technological materials to support pedagogical tasks. It is envisaged that the surrounding Agri TVET Schools may borrow

pedagogical materials, subject to arrangements with the CoVE. The physical setup of the resource centre is linked to infrastructure work and procurement of equipment (A.1.3.3.). Its management will be the responsibility of the CoVE (with an existing librarian in charge of documentary aspects and an existing equipment attendant for didactic and technological equipment). Regular assistance will be provided by the EF team for the management of the resource centre.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert in collaboration with the CoVE Project Advisers.
- Private suppliers (national/region and/or international) for the supply of equipment for the resource centres.

○ **1.4. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to link with their ecosystem (research institutions, other TVET Schools, private sector, communities).**

- A.1.4.1. Support the establishment of **partnerships with research institutions**, and the identification and implementation of innovative applied research activities centred, especially improving climate-resilience.

Description: It is interesting for the Agri CoVEs, and their environment, to contribute at their scale to applied research in the field of agriculture, animal health, and food processing. Research partners will be identified (including the RAB), and the possibilities of conducting controlled experiments will be considered, based on available resources (availability of field, technical and human resources, etc.), as part of the practical training for students and women from surrounding communities. The objective is for three Agri CoVE to act as hubs for piloting innovative research and bringing together research institutions, students and farmers for disseminating best-practices in modern resilient agriculture. Technical assistance from the EF team will be provided for establishing agreements with research partners, as well as for setting up and conducting applied research activities. Means will be made available to organise an annual research meeting day in each CoVE, for three consecutive years. Based on mutual interests, the objective is for CoVEs and research partners to continue collaborating after the project's completion.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Resilient Agriculture Expert, in collaboration with the CoVE Project Advisers.

- A.1.4.2. Support the establishment and management of **a knowledge exchange and learning network** among Agri TVET Schools on good practices in pedagogy, production unit management and enterprise cooperation.

Description: The lessons learned from the interventions piloted at targeted Agri CoVEs will be disseminated through a knowledge exchange and learning network to benefit Agri TVET Schools more widely. The Agri CoVEs should see the implementation of new approaches in pedagogy (and specifically a gender-sensitive pedagogy), production unit management, and cooperation with businesses. An experience-sharing session will be organised within the targeted Agri CoVEs, with technical assistance from the EF team; then a similar session will be organised with Agri TVET Schools nationally. Resources will be provided to organise these different sessions on an annual basis, over 3 years. EF's CoVE Project Advisers at will be responsible for animating these networks, and gradually prepare 2-3 members of the CoVEs' pedagogical team to take over after the end of the project.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert and the CoVE Project Advisers.

- A.1.4.3. Support the development of **partnerships with private sector** actors, including women's organisations and green actors.

Description: Partnerships between Agri TVET Schools and the private sector are often limited, particularly with women's organisations and green actors, limiting students' opportunities to internships and mentorships, and from gaining valuable practical skills. To change this situation, it is necessary to identify private sector partners and establish collaboration agreements with them (access to school equipment, internships, etc.). EF's technical assistance will support the targeted Agri CoVEs at all stages of establishing and managing these partnerships. Resources will be made available to organise an annual meeting over 3 consecutive years, allowing each CoVE to review existing collaborations with its partners and share best practices with all partners involved.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert and the CoVE Project Advisers.

- A.1.4.4. Support the engagement with **surrounding communities** and their linkage to Agri CoVEs students, including for practical activities and environmental projects.

Description: The idea is that Agri CoVEs will act as a hub for bringing together surrounding communities, where farmers, especially women, can come for learning, exchanging and trading. In close collaboration with RAB's Extension Field Officers, Farmer Master Trainers and farmers' organisations such as Imbaraga, leveraging their strong connections to the communities, targeted Agri CoVEs will be supported to create linkages with the surrounding communities: through session on the CoVEs' land or direct outreach to communities to account for farmers', especially women's, schedules, students will have the opportunity to demonstrate and put into practice the learnings from their training, especially on climate resilient practices. This will also allow students to reinforce their soft skills, such as leadership and presentation skills, while helping farmers optimise their efforts and take up productive resilient practices. Women and students will come together to lead on environmental projects, in collaboration with partner research institutions.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the CoVE Project Advisers, in collaboration with the TVET Expert, the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the Gender Expert.
- RAB's Extension Field Officers, Farmer Master Trainers and farmers' organisations such as Imbaraga will be close partners for the implementation of this activity.

○ 1.5. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to provide quality training and certification to farmers, especially women.

- A.1.5.1. Raise awareness on the importance of **Lifelong Learning (LLL)** among farmers in the surrounding communities, especially women.

Description: LLL allows farmers to get their practical skills recognised; yet many farmers, especially women, don't have access to information on this opportunity. Through awareness campaigns on LLL, staff at targeted Agri CoVEs and farmers from the surrounding communities, especially women, will be informed on what LLL is, what opportunities it provides and how to access it. The campaigns will be led by a national actor specialising in supporting farmers, such as the NGO Imbaraga which has a dense network of members across the country. RAB, through their Extension Field Officers and Farmer Master Trainers, will be closely involved. LLL awareness campaigns in the communities would take place with one campaign day per community, targeting 4 communities in the vicinity of each supported CoVE.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in community outreach (contractual service);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the CoVE Project Advisers;
- RAB's Extension Field Officers, Farmer Master Trainers and farmers' organisations such as Imbaraga will be close partners for the implementation of this activity.

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- A.1.5.2. Support the **training needs assessment of farmers** in the surrounding communities, especially women.

Description: Skills needs assessments often focus on the agricultural formal private sector but overlook the needs of farmers, especially women. Furthermore, depending on the location, needs can vary from one area to another, based on the crops and livestock raised, or dietary habits. An in-depth assessment of capacity-building needs will therefore be conducted in the surrounding communities of the targeted Agri CoVEs. The assessment will be led by a national actor with expertise in supporting farmers, such as the NGO Imbaraga, with the EF team providing methodological framing for the needs assessment, as well as activity monitoring. RAB, through their Extension Field Officers and Farmer Master Trainers, will be closely involved.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in community outreach (contractual service);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the CoVE Project Advisers.

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- A.1.5.3. Develop a **digital modular training programme** and **digital self-training material** centred around climate-resilient practices, made available to farmers on different devices (e.g., mobile phones, tablets).

Description: Once the training needs assessment for farmers has been conducted, an adapted training programme and self-training material will be developed. 10 priority topics will be identified, prioritising climate-resilient practices likely to have the most significant impact on farmers' operations, to be developed and produced in modular digital format both on mobile phones and tablets to facilitate access. The development of scenarios will be contracted through national expertise in training development. These scenarios will undergo validation through a one-day workshop facilitated by the consultant(s), bringing together key actors in agricultural development and extension services (especially RAB). The content of the scenarios should be accessible to farmers, especially women, and presented in Kinyarwanda. The production of videos will then be contracted to a private firm. The EF team will lead on contracting, technical support, and quality control of deliverables.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in writing and validation of training scenarios (contractual service);
- Private firm for video production (contractual service);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert.

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- A.1.5.4. Develop **an innovative mobile training programme**, using digital tools and centred around climate-resilient practices, and addressing women's unique time commitments and responsibilities by ensuring flexibility in scheduling and content delivery.

Description: To enable farmers, especially women, to access capacity-building opportunities, an innovative and flexible training programme based on digital tools will be implemented. The project will explore implementing a mobile training unit (using a vehicle adapted to the terrain) as a versatile and innovative solution for information and training to remote communities: it would provide on-site training to farmers, designed to deliver practical, hands-on instruction and demonstrations directly to rural communities, thus overcoming barriers related to accessibility and resource constraints that especially women face, and fostering community engagement with students from targeted Agri CoVEs. It would be equipped with educational resources, including a digital library, equipment and tools, and facilities to make it a fully functional, inclusive learning environment that can serve multiple locations. A mobile trainer would provide workshops and training sessions on topics like sustainable farming practices, crop management for food security and new agricultural technologies, as well as technical assistance to farmers. Videos will be produced and provided through tablets to farmers for self-learning, after instructions on how to use the tablets.

The mobile training unit would also allow to connect students to farmers by organizing hands-on field visits, collaborative training sessions, and joint research projects, facilitating real-world learning and knowledge exchange. Through community projects and technology demonstrations, students gain practical experience while assisting farmers with innovative practices and solutions. Farmers provide mentorship and share practical knowledge for a mutually beneficial engagement. The mobile training unit will serve as a point of contact for collaboration between farmers, students and also with agricultural extension services. Planning and a needs assessment will be conducted at the start to identify the target areas to cover, based on location, needs and potential impact, and define the expected outcomes of the mobile training unit.

Joint actions with RAB will be considered to ensure complementarity with the Farmer Field Schools run by extension services. Connections with some of RAB's research stations will also be promoted, as part of the deployment of localised applied research activities within the CoVEs. A 5-day training session will be offered to Extension Field Officers by the EF Technical Assistance to familiarise them with the content of the training programme designed for farmers.

The training programme for farmers aims to train 25 farmers, mostly women, per community, targeting 4 communities around each CoVE. Tablets lent to trained individuals will be collected at the end of each training cycle and made available to participants in the next cycle. Targeting of beneficiaries will be conducted at the start of activities based on predefined criteria (gender, age, etc.). Priority will be given to beneficiaries of the training to access the Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) programme.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in community outreach and farmer training (contractual service);
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, in collaboration with the Resilient Agriculture Expert and the CoVE Project Advisers.

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- A.1.5.5. Support the identification and training of **Farmer Master Trainers**, especially women, youth and persons with disability, in the communities, and the cascading of training delivered to fellow farmers.

Description: At the end of each of the 4 training cycles, based on predefined criteria and guidance provided by the mobile trainer, 10 Farmer Master Trainers will be selected per targeted Agri CoVE (from the 100 individuals trained per cycle per CoVE). These Farmer Master Trainers will undergo a 2-day training on adult training techniques so that they can independently share their knowledge with their community members. This activity will be conducted in close collaboration with RAB and complement the efforts of their Extension Field Officers in identifying and training Farmer Master Trainers.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Resilient Agriculture Expert in collaboration with the TVET Expert and CoVE Project Advisers.

Outputs contributing to Specific Objective 2:

- **2.1. Enhanced capacity of Agri TVET Schools at national level to deliver standardised quality career guidance and market opportunity linkages.**

The set of activities under this output are meant to benefit and apply to Agri TVET Schools at the national level, while the activities under the following outputs 2.2 and 2.3 will be piloted with the Agri CoVEs targeted in this project.

- A.2.1.1. Develop an **enterprise cooperation model** for Agri CoVEs, including women's organisations and green actors, benchmarked on existing successful models.

Description: To ensure the efficient collaboration between Agri CoVEs and agricultural private sector actors, a collaborative framework will be designed, outlining how the parties can work together, leveraging each other's strengths to achieve common goals of improving market linkages for women and youth, promoting sustainable agriculture and fostering innovation. The cooperation model will also provide guidance to Agri CoVEs on identifying, engaging and maintaining a strong relationship with the agricultural private sector for a long-term mutually beneficial collaboration. Special attention will be given to women's organisations, i.e. those that specifically focus on addressing the needs and interests of women in agriculture, promoting gender equality and women's empowerment; as well as green actors, i.e. those that prioritise environmental sustainability in their agricultural activities.

A benchmarking exercise will be conducted to identify best practices and build on existing successful collaboration models, and propose one that considers the specificities of women's organisations and green actors, adapted to the local realities. The development of the cooperation model will be entrusted to international expertise, in close collaboration with national partners, the Private Sector Foundation (PSF) and Agri CoVE representatives, and then be presented, amended and validated during a workshop with key stakeholders.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through international expertise, suggestively by leveraging EF's convention with the French Ministry for Agriculture and Food Security (MASA) and their technical expertise in promoting TVET Schools/enterprises cooperation;
- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, with support from the Gender Expert for the inclusion of women's organisations and overall gender sensitivity in the cooperation model, and the Resilient Agriculture Expert for the inclusion of green actors.
- The PSF and Agri CoVE representatives will be key partners and active contributors in the development of the cooperation model through a workshop,

to ensure their buy-in, and the relevance and feasibility of the cooperation model.

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- A.2.1.2. Develop gender-responsive and inclusive **work-based learning guidelines** for Agri CoVEs and private actors.

Description: The guidelines aim to facilitate the effective implementation of work-based learning programmes, and will outline standards and recommendations on how learning should be structured and assessed to ensure relevance in the context of a real agricultural working environment. They will serve as a roadmap for putting in place high-quality learning experiences that combine theory with practice. This will ensure that students gain valuable skills and experiences that prepare them for their future market integration.

The guidelines will address the specific needs and challenges faced by women and persons with disability, taking into account the different roles, responsibilities and constraints faced on the agricultural market. The objective is to provide equal opportunities to agricultural skills development and access to work-based learning. It is also necessary to adapt them to the specific context of Agri CoVEs, considering the specificity of the agricultural sector. Models of work-based learning have successfully been experimented with in Rwanda (notably in a MIFOTRA-funded project implemented by APEFE) from which learnings will be drawn.

This task will be entrusted to EF's technical assistance team for the formulation of the guidelines, in close collaboration with RTB's TVET experts, private sector actors and Agri CoVE representatives through a workshop. The validation of the guidelines will take place through a final workshop with stakeholders, including gender and inclusion partners.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert and the TVET Expert, with support from the Gender Expert and Resilient Agriculture Expert for gender mainstreaming and relevance to the agriculture sector
- Technical assistance on inclusion will be provided through national expertise (contractual service).
- A workshop with RTB for national TVET expertise, private actors from the agricultural sector (e.g., through PSF) and Agri CoVE representatives will be put in place during the guidelines' development phase, as well as a final validation session with key stakeholders.

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- A.2.1.3. Develop a **gender-sensitive school guidance framework** for secondary schools.

Description: A school guidance framework will be developed for secondary schools to better assist their students in their academic and career development in agriculture. It will outline how to conduct academic counselling and career guidance based on students' aspirations and skills, and include information on opportunities in the agricultural sector and on further education offered by Agri CoVEs. It is important that students' orientation towards enrolment in Agri CoVEs is based on reasoned choices and knowledge of the sector, its professions, and existing training pathways. Providing students with information contributes to their motivation, which in turn is a decisive factor in the success of their academic achievements and future career. The guidance will account for gender specificities, especially important given that young girls are predominant among agricultural TVET student and the majority of farmers are women. It will be developed in consultation with students, school staff, parents and Agri CoVE representatives to reflect diverse perspectives and ensure its relevance. A validation workshop will be held to obtain a finalised version of the framework.

Implementation modality:

Technical assistance provided through national expertise (contractual service) for the development of the framework, including an assessment of current practices and gaps in school guidance at secondary schools, and the facilitation of a working group with students, school staff, parents and Agri CoVE representatives.

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, in collaboration with the Gender Expert for ensuring the framework is gender-sensitive, and the CoVE Project Advisers for linkages with secondary schools.

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- A.2.1.4. Support Agri TVET actors in **advocating for work placements, apprenticeships, internships** towards agriculture market actors.

Description: Companies and other market actors (organisations, cooperatives, etc.) often lack the knowledge and awareness on the possibilities and mutual benefits offered by work placements, apprenticeships and internships. An assessment will be conducted with these actors to better understand the reasons for the barriers perceived or faced to offering work placements, apprenticeships and internships. To raise awareness on these aspects, an on-the-ground awareness campaign will be conducted with representatives from Agri CoVEs. Clear advocacy messaging and promotion materials on the mutual benefits of work placements, apprenticeships and internships will be developed to be shared with both Agri TVET actors (e.g., RTB, RP, CoVEs), PSF and other market actors.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert and the CoVE Project Advisers in collaboration with representatives from the three targeted Agri CoVEs.
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in developing successful advocacy campaigns and materials (contractual service).

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- A.2.1.5. Develop and/or review **short courses on soft skills, entrepreneurship, leadership, cooperative management**.

Description: Short courses will be developed in subjects that are essential for the integration of women and youth on the agricultural market: soft skills (including communication, teamwork, problem-solving, emotional intelligence and negotiation), entrepreneurship, leadership and cooperative management. The courses will be offered by Agri CoVEs and will be designed to target both students and farmers, especially women, from the neighbouring communities. A clear demand exists for training from women farmers to enhance their skills, especially soft and management skills that are crucial for their agricultural activities but also social development. Conscious of women's activities and responsibilities (agricultural, personal and family), the format of short courses has been chosen for more flexibility and easier access for women, and is also suitable as a complement to students' curricula. Three-day workshops develop the short courses will bring together experts from the relevant domains. A validation workshop with key stakeholders will be facilitated upon completion of the four short courses.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the TVET Expert, with support from the Gender Expert to ensure gender is taken into account in the courses.
- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in curricula development and in the different subjects (contractual service).

○ **2.2. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to deliver quality career and transition to work guidance.**

The set of activities under this output will be piloted specifically with the Agri CoVEs targeted in this project.

- A.2.2.1. Establish a **career guidance and market integration unit**, including the identification and training of dedicated staff.

Description: Targeted Agri CoVEs will be supported in setting up a specialised department with their centres, dedicated to providing career guidance services and facilitating the integration of students into the agricultural market. A space in each targeted centre will be dedicated for the unit through the rehabilitation/extension of their infrastructure (outcome 1). 2 CoVE staff members will manage the unit and act as focal points providing assistance during defined periods. They will be supported by EF's CoVE Project Advisers and undergo training prior to the establishment of the units. The unit will play an instrumental role in the implementation of activities aiming at supporting linkages of youth to market opportunities (output 2.3).

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, in collaboration with the CoVE Project Advisers for direct support to Agri CoVE staff in managing the unit.
- Private suppliers (national/region and/or international) for the supply of equipment for the resource centres.

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- A.2.2.2. Develop an **outreach and communication strategy on jobs and opportunities** in agriculture, particularly directed towards women and promoting green opportunities, including developing communication materials.

Description: An outreach and communication strategy will be developed for how information about agricultural jobs and opportunities is communicated through Agri CoVEs to their students, and to farmers from surrounding communities, especially women. This will include conducting an assessment of what information is needed (especially by women and youth), defining watch mechanisms to identify the opportunities (e.g., dedicated staff, continuous engagement with market actors) and defining adapted outreach channels to women and youth (e.g., prints, digitally through the career unit, collaboration with women's associations). All available information on jobs and opportunities, especially green ones, will be collected and consolidated. Communication materials will be created (e.g., flyers), and digital access will be made available for students at the career guidance units, and also for their parents who often influence study choices, especially for girls. Ultimately, the objectives of the outreach and communication policy are to increase awareness on the different career opportunities available in agriculture, especially green ones; to promote the agricultural sector as an attractive and viable career option; to provide up-to-date information on job openings, training programmes and internships available; encourage diversity and inclusion on the agricultural market, especially of women.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided through national expertise in communication strategies (contractual service). Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, in collaboration with the Gender Expert and Resilient Agriculture Expert, and

CoVE Project Advisers for direct support to Agri CoVE staff in implementing the outreach and communication strategies.

○ **2.3. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to support linkages to market/productive opportunities.**

The set of activities under this output will be piloted specifically with the Agri CoVEs targeted in this project.

- A.2.3.1. Support the setting up of an **internship programme**, and a **business mentorship programme** to support graduates develop and implement their business models.

Description:

Led by the newly established career guidance and market integration unit at each targeted Agri CoVE, the programmes will aim to provide students with hands-on experience and practical skills in a business environment, as well as support and advice on starting and growing an enterprise.

Targeted Agri CoVEs will be supported in developing and implementing a planned approach to guide them in effectively setting up and managing internship and business mentorship programmes. This will include defining the objectives of the programmes and necessary actions to select, support and evaluate participating students, as well as how to identify and engage internship hosts and business mentors.

The CoVEs will be supported in determining the structure, format and duration (e.g., full- or part-time, summer-time, semester-long, project-based) of the internship programme so that it is fully embedded into and align with the curricula offered. They will also be supported in putting in place a structured selection and application process for students; ensuring ongoing supervision and support during the internships; establishing evaluation and feedback mechanisms for the programme.

Through the business mentorship programme, aspiring entrepreneurs will be paired with experienced workers for advice and guidance on the development of their business ideas. Targeted Agri CoVEs will be supported with selecting, training and engaging mentors with relevant expertise, willing to share knowledge and insights; defining mentor-student matching criteria, such as goals, interests and expertise; facilitating regular meetings and learning exchanges; establishing processes for evaluating the effectiveness of the programme in supporting students' business models, and for collecting feedback from mentors and students for continuous programme improvement.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, in collaboration with the CoVE Project Advisers for direct support to the Agri CoVE staff.

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- A.2.3.2. Support **linkages of students to internship and mentorship opportunities**, including within the neighbouring communities and hosted by Farmer Master Trainers.

Description: All networks of professionals (private, cooperatives, individual farmers, etc.) will be mobilised to create internship and mentorship opportunities for graduating students. Market actors with a regional presence that can offer internship and mentorship opportunities aligned with students' interests, skills and career goals will be mapped out. These will include e.g., cooperatives, local enterprises, regional branches

of larger agricultural businesses, women's organisations. Targeted Agri CoVEs will benefit from the newly developed enterprise cooperation model (see activity 2.1.1) to guide them in establishing partnerships with the identified organisations. The CoVEs will be supported with outreach and relationship-building efforts. The hosting of career fairs where agriculture market actors and youth come together to exchange about opportunities for internships and mentorships will be facilitated. Additionally, guest speaker events will be facilitated where successful entrepreneurs will be invited to share experiences and insights on entrepreneurship.

Mentors will be identified among local agriculture businesses and organisations, as well as agricultural workers from the neighbouring communities. The Farmer Master Trainers trained within the project will also be mobilised for mentorships, as well as RAB's Extension Field Officers. The technical assistance will contribute to facilitating the matching of mentors with mentees, and for providing ongoing support and follow-up to students throughout their internship and mentorship experiences.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, in collaboration with the CoVE Project Advisers for direct support to the targeted Agri CoVEs in fostering internship and mentorship opportunities.
- The PSF and other market actors, such as cooperatives, with a presence in the regions of the targeted Agri CoVEs, as well as the communities, Farmer Master Trainers and Extension Field Officers will be mobilised.

▪ A.2.3.3. Support linkages of women to **cooperatives**.

Description: research and experience show that women who are members of cooperatives have easier access to capacity building, inputs, financing, etc., as well as peer support, thus improving their living conditions and those of their families. Connections between women farmers and cooperatives will be facilitated, enabling women to benefit from cooperative initiatives either by joining one or forming one. Cooperatives in the areas surrounding the three Agri CoVEs will be identified, with a focus on those that align with the interests, needs and goals of women. They will be primarily agricultural cooperatives, but other types of membership groups will also be considered if they are deemed valuable for the women farmers' activities and empowerment. Partnerships will be established with the cooperatives that are keen to support and engage women farmers, and their needs and requirements for membership identified. For non-women-only organisations, the management and members will be sensitised on gender, e.g., the importance of women's representation, gender diversity, women's specific needs and challenges (flexible scheduling, access, etc.). In collaboration with cooperative representatives, awareness raising about the cooperative model, opportunities with them, responsibilities and benefits to women farmers will be conducted within the neighbouring communities. Support will be provided to those interested in becoming engaged members.

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance provided by the EF team, led by the Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, in collaboration with the CoVE Project Advisers for the identification and relationship with cooperatives, and the Gender Expert for gender sensitisation activities.
- Cooperative representatives will actively be engaged in awareness raising events with women.

▪ A.2.3.4. Support linkages of **women and youth entrepreneurs with financial institutions**.

Description: research shows that women farmers and youth face many barriers in accessing financial products and services due to, among other things, a lack of information, collateral or credit history. This leads to situations of underinvestment that negatively impacts the development and profitability of their agricultural enterprises.

Financial institutions that offer products and services suitable for women and youth entrepreneurs will be identified, including banks, credit unions, microfinance institutions and others offering specific support to women and youth in entrepreneurship. Partnerships will be established with these institutions to facilitate women and youth's access to financial products and services that meet their needs. Women and youth interested in entrepreneurship will be offered financial literacy and education training to ensure informed decisions for their enterprises, and individual assistance will be provided in preparing business plans and loans applications to improve their credit-worthiness according to the institutions' criteria. Conscious of the existing barriers for access to finance for women and youth (collateral, credit history, etc.), alternative financing options and guarantee solutions will be explored, as well as flexible lending criteria advocated for.

The project aims to support at least 90 entrepreneurs accessing financial support for their enterprises (an average of 30 per targeted Agri CoVE).

Implementation modality:

- Technical assistance through national expertise in financial literacy training and education (contractual service);
 - Technical assistance provided by the EF team: Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert, CoVE Project Advisers;
 - Financial institutions' representatives as active partners to the targeted Agri CoVEs and activities towards women and youth.
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c. Target groups and beneficiaries

i. Direct beneficiaries:

- 900 students, young girls and young men, persons with disability, from 03 supported Centres of Vocational Excellence in agriculture (Agri CoVEs);
- 1,200 farmers, particularly women and including persons with disability, from the surrounding areas of the 03 supported Agri CoVEs
- Staff from the 03 supported Agri CoVEs (about 24 management and administrative staff, 108 pedagogical staff).

These targets assume that the three pre-identified TVET schools - EAV Bigogwe, TSS Kisaro, EAV Rushashi - will be supported, but the initial needs assessment at the project's start will confirm the final selection of schools and final targets.

ii. Indirect beneficiaries:

- Staff from institutions involved in TVET and agriculture (RTB, NESA, RAB...);
- Students from other Agri TVET Schools;
- Local authorities in the targeted districts;
- Stakeholders in the agricultural sector, e.g., private actors, agricultural organisations, cooperatives...;
- Rural communities in the surrounding areas of the supported Agri CoVEs.

d. Cross-cutting themes

i. Gender equality and empowerment of women and girls

This action is labelled G2: gender equality is fundamental in its design and expected results. Objectives and activities have been developed to combat gender inequalities and with the aim of strengthening the socio-economic empowerment of women. The design of the project was informed by the gender analysis, specifically focused on agriculture and TVET, conducted by the European Training Foundation (2023), as well as other gender studies such as MINAGRI's study on Women's Empowerment in Agriculture (2020), to ensure that the interventions are relevant to women's needs and realities on the ground. Despite progress made in the last decade in skills development and notably in the agriculture sector, poverty of women is a major outstanding challenge for gender equality, and women continue to be under-represented in economic life. Women have restricted access to skills development initiatives, productive resources such as land, finance, credit and markets, and disparities exist in terms of literacy rates.

The Action will be implemented through a set of gender transformative approaches, led by the EF project team's Gender Expert, to holistically support women's skills development in the agriculture sector, to support them in gradually shifting from subsistence farming to a market-oriented agriculture and open for sustainable opportunities in agriculture for women. The project's progress towards gender equality will be assessed continuously, and gender-disaggregated indicators are integrated into the project's logical framework.

The European Consensus for Development states that the EU and its Member States will promote inclusion of men and women in all their diversity, and participation, non-discrimination, equality and equity, transparency and accountability. Thus, the action will rely on methodologically sound and policy-relevant empirical research and develop the evidence base for its projects to foster a gender-transformative approach.

ii. Climate resilience and sustainability

The Climate Risk Assessment screening concluded that this action is no or low risk. However, climate is a significant objective for this action. Thus, the agricultural best practices to be integrated in the short courses offers will tackle activities linked to the Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC)-targets and aligned with requirements of adaptation to climate change (promotion of climate resilient crops and livestock, climate resilient post-harvest and value addition facilities and technologies, strengthened crop management practices, sustainable land use management practices, irrigation and water management) and mitigation (actions linked to fertilisers efficiency, soil conservation, improved livestock management, compost production). The action will contribute to meaningful and equal participation and leadership of women in climate adaptation and mitigation policy and decision-making. The awareness and training actions for women, notably through dedicated short courses on climate-resilient practices, will enable women to become aware of the impacts of climate change on their agricultural activities and equip them with the necessary skills to adapt their practices to these challenges. These interventions will be led by a dedicated full-time Resilient Agriculture Expert within the EF project team. Organising women into cooperative structures will reinforce this awareness and facilitate the sharing of climate adaptation skills among them, particularly through the Farmer Master Trainers.

iii. Disability and inclusion

This action is labelled as D1 in the OECD Disability DAC codes. This implies that the action is considered relevant for inclusion of persons with disabilities. It will include persons with disability and will ensure that social inclusion runs as a red line throughout the action. The Rwanda Population and Housing Census of 2012 estimated that 446,453 people aged five years and above had different types of disabilities, 50.4% and 49.6% of whom were female and male, respectively. Promoting the rights and wellbeing of persons with disability is embedded in Rwanda's inclusive and sustainable development

agenda. The action will not implement specific activities for groups of persons with disability; however, it will mobilise intermittent expertise to ensure that specific activities integrate disability and inclusion issues (i.e. infrastructure activities, capacity building of teaching staff and TVET institutions...)

e. Stakeholders

This action will require a mix of Rwandan entities in the TVET and the agriculture sector, public and private, as well as institutions specialised in gender equality and women's empowerment.

i. On the TVET side:

- **The Ministry of Education (MINEDUC):** the central government body taking overall responsibility on developing, reviewing and guiding the implementation of the education policy and strategic plans;
Roles and involvement in the action: chairmanship of the Strategic Steering Committee.
- **Rwanda TVET Board (RTB):** its mission is to promote quality TVET at the levels 1-5 aimed at fast tracking socio-economic development of the country. RTB's core responsibilities are designing curricula, teaching materials, trainer's guides, methodologies and establishing training methods for TVET; promoting use of ICT in TVET; coordinating TVET programmes and activities; coordinating the trainers' capacity development and monitoring their management;
Roles and involvement in the action: RTB is the main beneficiary partner of the action, and assumes the chairmanship of the operational governance committees.
- **Rwanda Polytechnic (RP):** established in 2017, RP is responsible for the TVET levels 6, 7, 8 and 9 (higher education) and has duties related to the education provision, curriculum development and research. 8 Integrated Polytechnic Regional Colleges (IPRCs) are under the RP, of which 4 offer agriculture-related trades. The project particularly concerns TVET levels 1 to 5, under the responsibility of the RTB.
Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Operational Coordination Committee.
- **The National Examination and School Inspection Authority (NESA):** established in 2020, NESA is in charge of the national examination of general education and TVET schools, for standards and quality assurance. NESA also accredits TVET Schools and certifies TVET graduates. NESA plays a key role in the accreditation of CoVEs.
Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Operational Coordination Committee. NESA will bring its expertise in defining the CoVE concept, developing the framework and implementation tools, as well as supporting selected TVET Agri Centres in their transition to Agri CoVEs.
- **Ministry of Public Service and Labour (MIFOTRA):** is responsible inter alia for ensuring a beneficial environment for the creation of decent jobs and equipping the workforce with necessary skills to increase productivity and competitiveness for sustainable development. Within MIFOTRA, the Chief Skills Office is provisioned to align skills development with labour market demands. It is mandated to provide effective oversight and coordination in the skills development and employment promotion ecosystem. For these purposes, MIFOTRA coordinates the private sector-led **Sector Skills Council (SSC) in agriculture** (previously under RDB);
Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Strategic Steering Committee. The SSC Agri will be involved in the identification of missing skills and needed ones on the agriculture labour market.
- **The Rwanda Development Board (RDB):** is responsible for driving economic growth and development in Rwanda by facilitating investment, promoting exports, and fostering an enabling environment for business and innovation.
Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Operational Coordination Committee.

ii. On the Agriculture side:

- **The Ministry of Agriculture and Animal Resources (MINAGRI):** has the mission of promoting the sustainable development of a modern, efficient, and competitive agriculture and livestock sector. Its Gender Mainstreaming Strategy is aligned to the Fourth Strategic Plan for Agriculture Transformation (PSTA4);

Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Strategic Steering Committee.

- **The Rwanda Agriculture Board (RAB),** which oversees research and development of agricultural and animal resources through dedicated extension services. Several RAB stations are distributed across the country. RAB also operates a country-wide network of Farmer Field Schools (FFS), a form of non-formal education with experimental plots and a trained “farmer facilitator”;

Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Operational Coordination Committee. The RAB will be involved regarding the development and implementation of the innovative mobile training programme, through its extension service, with which synergies will be sought locally to strengthen the training actions implemented by the CoVEs. Connections could also be made with some of its research stations, as part of the deployment of localised applied research activities within the CoVEs.

- The **Ministry of Environment (MoE)** is in charge of developing policies and programmes related to environment and climate change; Its agency, the **Rwanda Environment Management Authority (REMA)**, whose mission is ‘to promote and ensure the protection of the environment and sustainable management of natural resources through decentralised structures of governance’;

iii. On gender equality and women’s empowerment:

- **The Ministry of Gender and Family Promotion (MIGEPROF):** is the Central Government institution mandated to ensure strategic coordination of policy implementation in the areas of gender and family promotion, women’s empowerment and child rights protection. It plays a leading role in the implementation of gender agenda;

Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Strategic Steering Committee.

- **Gender Monitoring Office (GMO):** oversees effective implementation of the national, regional and international commitments related to gender equality. It is an institution that upholds gender accountability for inclusive sustainable development in Rwanda;

Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Operational Coordination Committee.

iv. On the private sector side:

- **The Private Sector Foundation (PSF):** first professional organisation in the country, dedicated to promote and represent the interests of Rwandan businesses. The PSF regroups more than 10 professional chambers, among which the Chamber of Agriculture, and the Chamber of Women Entrepreneurs;

Roles and involvement in the action: member of the Operational Coordination Committee.

- **Cooperatives of Farmers and Agriculture workers; Professional organisations** representing farmers’ rights, such as Imbaraga Farmers Organisation (NGO).

Roles and involvement in the action: Involvement in actions with farmers such as awareness campaigns, assessment of capacity-building needs, training.

f. Complementarity with other actions

Simultaneously with the ongoing action, LuxDev will carry out a twin project funded by Luxembourg’s Ministry of Foreign Affairs, targeting 3-5 Agri CoVEs located geographically outside the intervention area

of this action, in the Eastern and Southern provinces. The EF-led and LuxDev-led projects have been developed in close collaboration between the two agencies to ensure complementarity and synergies, especially for the technical assistance provided to RTB and engagement with institutions at national level. Regular consultations and joint governance instances will be put in place to ensure the continued smooth collaboration once the projects have started.

The project complements other ongoing actions supporting the Rwandan agriculture and TVET sectors. Notably, USAID's three Feed the Future Rwanda projects: i) *Modernising Agriculture* (2023-2028, 28 MUSD, implemented by Cultivating New Frontiers in Agriculture and Market Share Associates) which aims to increase agricultural productivity and climate resilience, and encourage private sector investment in agriculture; ii) *Kungahara Wagura Amasoko* (2021–2026, +18 MUSD, implemented by RTI) which aims to enhance high-value agricultural exports; and iii) *Hanga Akazi* (2022–2027, +17 MUSD, implemented by RTI) which aims to enhance job creation and foster entrepreneurship in the agricultural sector.

Additionally, the project will build on lessons learned from past/ongoing actions in the TVET sector, especially KOICA's and KfW's projects aiming to strengthen TVET systems, improve training quality and align skills with labour market demand. Regular consultations and information exchanges will take place with the Rwandan authorities and technical and financial partners involved in agricultural TVET (KOICA, USAID, KfW etc.) to ensure coherence among various intervention.

4. Governance and implementation arrangements

a. Implementation modalities

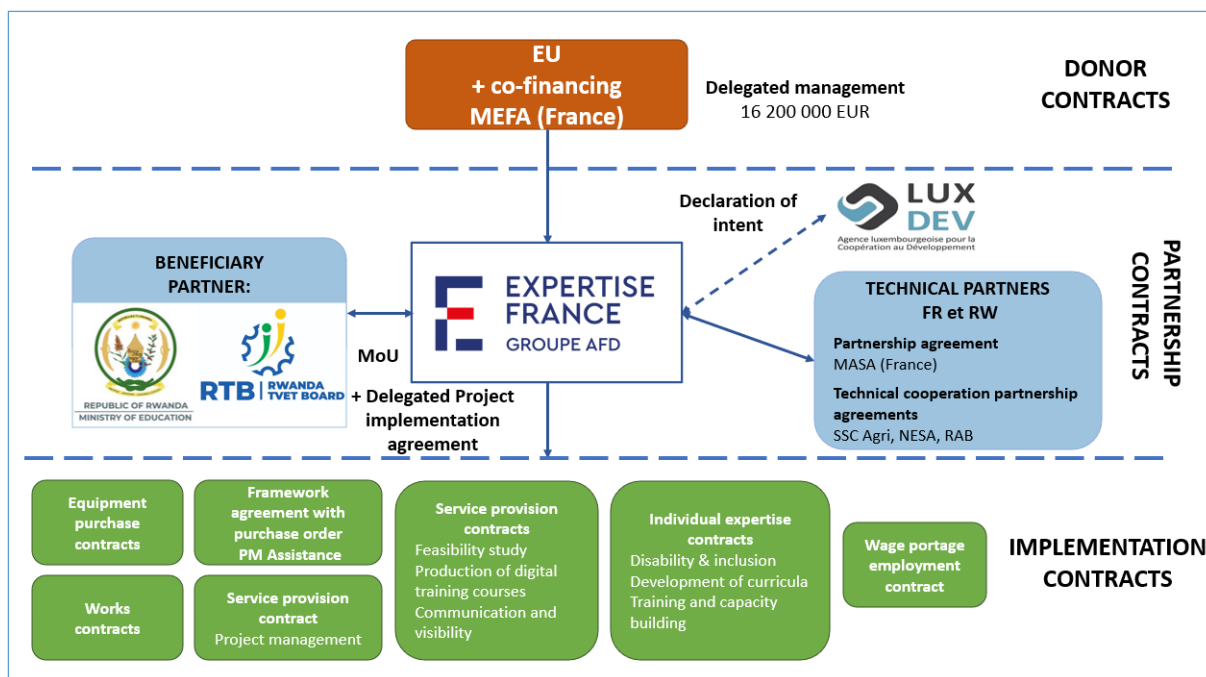
Expertise France will be the sole implementing agency for the funds jointly provided by the EU and the French Ministry of Foreign Affairs. It will be fully responsible for managing these funds and for ensuring the proper execution of the action as defined in the agreement between Expertise France and the EU Delegation. A delegated management agreement with the EU Delegation will be signed, authorising Expertise France to contract for the execution of activities.

The project will be implemented through 3 main sets of activities:

Mobilisation of expertise: expertise will be mobilised for i) methodological and technical advice, including for the development of curricula, action plans, evaluation guides, and technical expertise on disability and inclusion; ii) capacity building, such as training of trainers and change management; iii) facilitating networking and exchanges for TVET institutions with their ecosystem, including agriculture market actors, research institutions, communities, etc.; iv) long-term technical expertise in TVET, Employment and Private Sector Engagement, Gender and Resilient Agriculture, recruited as part of the project team; and v) facilitating partnerships between Rwandan public actors (SSC Agri, NESA, RAB) and French ones (through MASA).

Contracting for infrastructure rehabilitation and extension in the targeted Agri CoVEs: as the delegated infrastructure project manager for RTB, EF will contract for infrastructure expertise through assistance for infrastructure project management, which will include support in drafting specifications, contracting and analysing offers. An Infrastructure Project Manager will then be contracted for the management and monitoring of the works at the different sites led by a construction company.

Procurement of equipment for the targeted Agri CoVEs: both pedagogical (agricultural, animal health and agro-processing; tablets) and non-pedagogical (furniture for offices, dormitories, etc.) equipment will be procured through this project and provided to the targeted Agri CoVEs, following a needs assessment and excellency requirements. Suppliers will be identified, locally/regionally first-hand and internationally when necessary, and contracted.



b. Implementing partners

Expertise France will establish a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the project's beneficiary partner RTB, MINEDUC's national agency for the development and coordination of TVET. The MoU will outline the roles and responsibility of both parts and will include a delegated infrastructure project implementation agreement signed to enable Expertise France to conduct and supervise the infrastructure activities on behalf of RTB.

A declaration of intent will be signed between EF and LuxDev to formalise the collaboration during the project period, and regular consultation and governance mechanisms will be established to ensure the sharing of objectives, strategies and mutual experiences arising from the implementation of the two projects.

Expertise France will also leverage its partnership and framework agreement with the French MASA for mobilisation of French expertise. More specifically, it is envisaged to mobilise CEFAGRI (Centre d'Expertise et de Formation Agricole), a network under MASA whose objective is to share French expertise in agricultural education and training, by facilitating exchanges and cooperation between French agricultural educational institutions and their international counterparts.

Additionally, partnership agreements for technical cooperation will be put in place with other national public actors to leverage their expertise and ensure their active engagement in the implementation of the action. These will include national partners such as RAB, whose Extension Field Officers will play a key role in community engagement and outreach to farmers, as well as their research stations for the deployment of localised applied research activities piloted by the Agri CoVEs; NESA, for accreditation and evaluation of CoVEs; SCC Agri, for strengthened collaboration between TVET institutions and the agricultural market actors.

c. Governance

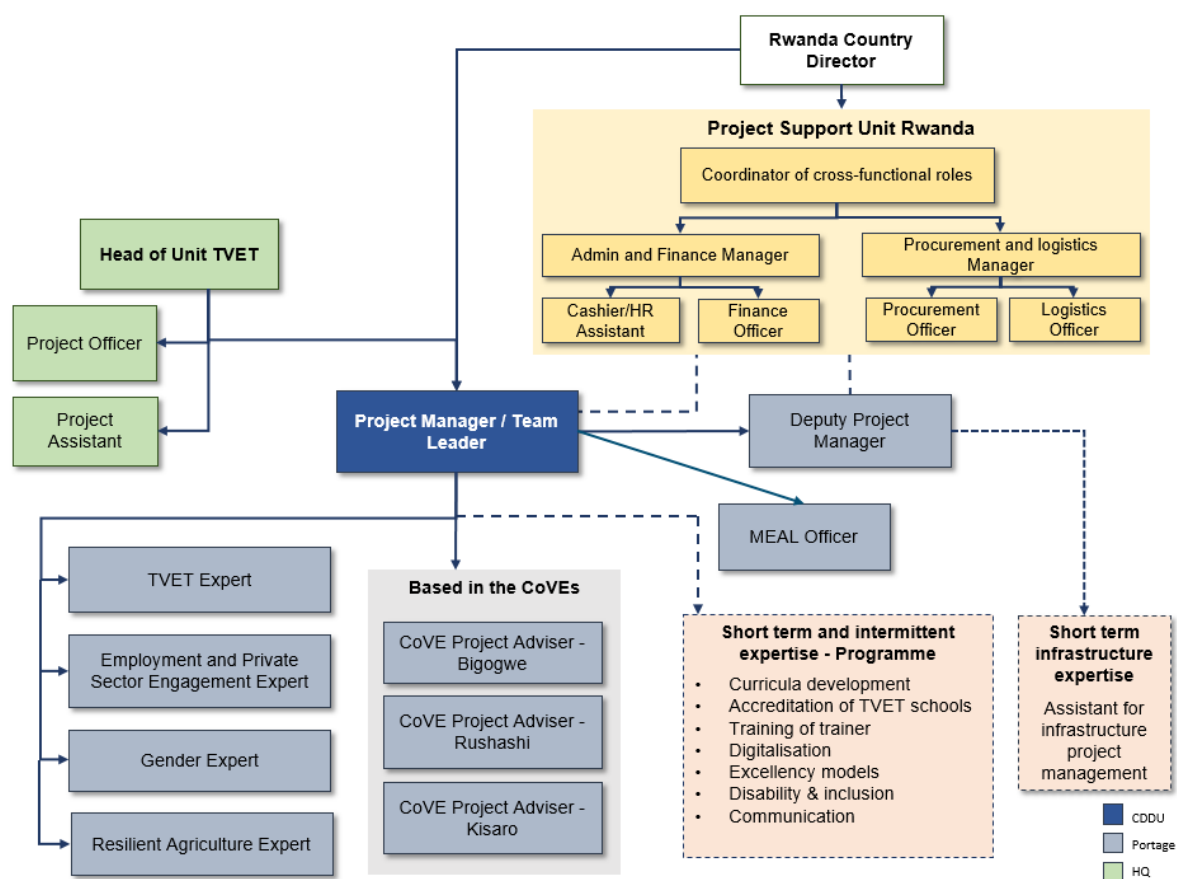
The governance of the project will be carried out in part jointly with LuxDev, to ensure regular coordination and synergies between this project and the LuxDev-led one, implemented in different regions and TVET schools than those supported by the EU/EF project. This will also ensure a strong Team Europe collaboration.

As a result, four distinct governance structures will be established, each with specific roles to fulfil:

- Strategic Steering Committee: It will be chaired by MINEDUC and co-chaired by the EU Delegation and the Ministry of Foreign and European Affairs of Luxembourg. The committee will include representatives from the following ministries: MINAGRI, MoE, MIFOTRA, MIGEPROF, as well as a representative from RTB (as beneficiary partner), the Embassy of France, EF and LuxDev. The committee meets once a year and can convene as often as necessary upon request from a ministry highly involved in the action. It assumes a strategic role: definition of strategic orientations for the project, validation of major decisions and resources, supervision of goal achievement, coordination and communication among stakeholders, representation.
- Operational Coordination Committee: It will be chaired by RTB and will include representatives from national executing agencies attached to the ministries involved in the action: RP, NESAs, RAB; RDB; SSC Agri; REMA; GMO, as well as representatives from the PSF and MASA (key partners in the project), EF and LuxDev; the representatives of LuxDev's and EF's targeted Agri CoVEs will also participate as members of this committee. It meets twice a year and ensures the implementation of strategic decisions taken by the Strategic Steering Committee. This committee has an operational role and leads on the coordination of activities and progress monitoring, management of resources and operational risks, communication and reporting.
- Technical Coordination Committee: This committee has an operational role, chaired by EF, and includes representatives from RTB, LuxDev and LuxDev's and EF's targeted Agri CoVEs. The committee meets every 3 months to provide a regular forum for collaboration on one or more key project themes and exchange on lessons learned.
- Infrastructure Works Monitoring Committee: It is chaired by EF and brings together the stakeholders involved in the infrastructure construction and rehabilitation works, to ensure the smooth progress and coordination of the infrastructure activities: representatives of RTB, the targeted Agri CoVEs, the Assistant for infrastructure project management, the Prime Contractor for infrastructure management and the construction companies. The roles of this committee include the supervision and monitoring of works, coordination and control, management of delays and risks, communication and reporting.

d. Indicative project team

The project team will be comprised of an operational and technical team responsible for the successful implementation of the project and led by the Project Manager, and support functions through the EF Project Support Unit. The project team is based in Kigali and in the three targeted districts.



The operational and technical team will include 10 team members and will be led by the Project Manager, responsible for the overall planning and supervision of the project, as well as for managing the team and identifying the short-term expertise required for the project. The Project Manager will also be in charge of maintaining a strong relationship with the project stakeholders, including the partners, project beneficiary RTB and EU Delegation in Kigali. They are accountable for the project's successful completion, including risk management, towards the EF Headquarters. They liaise with the Coordinator leading the team of the Shared Support Unit to ensure smooth support to the project.

The Project Manager will be assisted by a Deputy Project Manager who will lead the administrative and financial monitoring and reporting for the project, as well as the procurement and contracting activities. in close collaboration with the EF Country Office's Procurement team for purchasing processes and control, and with EF Headquarters' support. The Deputy Manager will also be the focal point to the Infrastructure Project Management Assistance (including preparation of the specifications, supplier selection, contracting, work supervision).

The team will further be composed of **four full-time national experts, who will provide technical assistance in (i) TVET, (ii) Employment and Private Sector Engagement, (iii) Gender and (iv) Resilient Agriculture**. The TVET Expert will lead the coordination of activities under Outcome 1 on quality training and the development of the CoVE model development. They will also be in close contact with experts at RTB and other TVET institutions. The Employment and Private Sector Engagement Expert will lead on activities under Outcome 2 on market linkages and integration of women and youth. They will be in close contact with the PSF and its members, and play a crucial role in linking the agricultural market actors with Agri CoVEs through mutually beneficial partnerships. Finally, the Gender and Resilient Agriculture Experts will provide essential technical advice in their areas of expertise, ensuring gender and climate mainstreaming.

CoVE Project Advisers will be based in each of the supported CoVEs and responsible for coordinating the implementation of activities in their centre and district, for facilitating coordination and communication

between Kigali, districts and centres, for supporting with reporting and for facilitating partnerships and the mobilisation of regional actors.

A half-time **Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning (MEAL) Officer** will also be part of the project team, in charge of developing the project's MEAL framework, data collection/analysis tools, and accountability and learning processes. Additionally, they will lead on the MEAL activities, including carrying out the baseline (or coordinate with external expertise if necessary), monitoring project activities and indicators, coordinate data collection with partners and the targeted centres, coordinate the external evaluations, and lead on learning activities and stakeholder engagement. They will be supported by the MEAL Coordinator from EF Headquarters, and work closely with the Experts on the team, especially the Gender Expert to ensure that the Gender Action Plan aligns with the MEAL framework, and the Agriculture Resilient Expert.

The operational and technical team will benefit from the Project Support Unit based in Kigali, essential for the smooth implementation of the project. The functions include: accounting and treasury management, audit coordination, administrative support (taxes, statutes, etc.), legal advice and procurement processes, logistics and planning for events and workshops, and human resources management.

A Headquarter-based Head of Unit for TVET (10%, replaced by the Country Director when in post), Project Officer (30%) and Project Assistant (20% for the start of the project, and 10% from January 2025) will ensure the liaison between the Rwanda-based team and EF Headquarters, provide technical advice, and lead the capitalisation and quality control activities.

e. Implementation period and location

The implementation period of the project is scheduled to start on 01 September 2024 for a duration of 60 months, until 31 August 2029.

The inception phase will take place during the first six months of the project, during which the following activities will take place/be initiated:

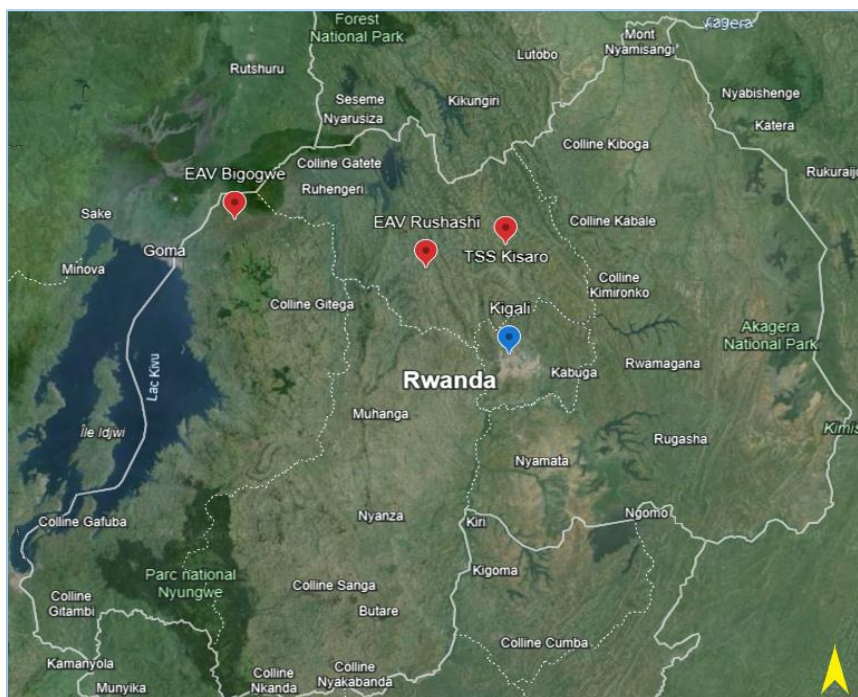
- Recruit and train the EF project team.
- Establish partnership agreements with RTB and MINEDUC.
- Establish the project steering committee.
- Organise the kick-off meeting with RTB, EU Delegation, LuxDev, the French Embassy and other project stakeholders.
- Conduct the needs assessment and benchmarking analysis for infrastructure and equipment, and based on the findings, confirm the final number of centres to be supported by this project.
- Review and adapt project documents, including the logframe and risk matrix, and develop the action plan for the project's first year.
- Collect baseline indicators.
- Engage with project stakeholders, including those implementing actions with high potential for synergies.
- Draft the project procedures manual.

The closeout phase will take place during the last three months of the project, in 2029.

The project will be carried out in Rwanda, in Kigali and in the Western and Northern provinces, at targeted TVET schools and in their neighbouring communities. The following three TVET schools have been pre-identified at this stage, and the initial needs assessment at the project's start will confirm the final selection of schools to be supported within the scope of the budget:

- **Ecole Agricole et Vétérinaire Bigogwe**, a government aided school in the Western province, Nyabihu district;
- **Technical Secondary School Kisaro**, a public school in the Northern province, Rulindo district;

- **Ecole Agricole et Vétérinaire Rushashi**, a public school in the Northern province, Gakenke district.



Map n°1: Location of the three targeted Agri CoVEs in Rwanda.

MoUs will be established with the targeted Agri CoVEs outlining the roles and responsibilities of each party, and the activities to be carried out by the CoVE Project Advisers and the project team. The project will not provide the targeted CoVEs with financial resources for their own management.

The three TVET schools currently offer training in the trades agriculture and animal health, as well as some other non-agricultural programmes (mining, computer systems & architecture). With their evolution into Agri CoVEs, they will exclusively offer training in the trades agriculture, animal health and food processing, for qualification levels ranging from 3 to 5. The sizing of the project aims to develop Agri CoVEs that can accommodate 540 students per centre, with gender parity, and a gender-sensitive and inclusive infrastructure that can accommodate all boarding students.

5. Sustainability of the action

Different dimensions of sustainability will be taken into account to ensure that the project contributes to and aligns with the environmental, social and economic objectives of the Government of Rwanda and EU's international cooperation priorities.

To ensure a lasting impact beyond the project's timeframe, the project will provide technical assistance to build institutional capacity among TVET institutions for the sustainable transfer and consolidation of skills. The sustainability of the action relies on continuous participation and engagement of Rwandan stakeholders in decision-making and implementation processes, ensuring the acquisition of necessary skills and ownership. This participatory approach avoids reliance on external technical assistance.

By strengthening the agriculture sector, key for Rwanda's economic development, the project contributes to the country's economic sustainability. Additionally, socio-economic sustainability is reinforced by supporting women's and youth's access to improved skills adapted to labour market needs

and their market integration through entrepreneurship and job opportunities – fostering a more equitable and cohesive society.

The project promotes social sustainability by putting gender and inclusion at its centre, promoting social cohesion, gender equality, inclusion and community development. Similarly, the project emphasises environmental sustainability and supports the green transition by promoting climate-resilient agriculture and sustainable practices, by conducting environmental impact assessments for the infrastructure works and by prioritising local/regional procurement of equipment to the extent it is possible. Specific expertise in both gender and resilient agriculture within the project team will ensure the mainstreaming of the two themes.

The project is anchored in national priorities for the development of the CoVE model in agriculture, and by piloting the model in targeted Agri CoVEs, lessons learned will contribute to the successful rollout of the CoVE model to other TVET schools. Partnering with RTB and engaging with national agriculture and TVET actors, as well as with target groups of women, youth and persons with disability, ensures that the interventions are relevant to the national context and needs, for a sustainable impact. Sustainability is ensured through various mechanisms of dialogue, consultation, and networking that have facilitated the creation of multiple links between Agri CoVEs and TVET Schools, extension services, research, agricultural businesses, cooperatives, financial institutions, etc., links that should endure beyond the lifespan of the project.

6. Risk Assessment

The risk assessment related to this action highlighted the following:

Risks	Corrective/mitigation actions
Low involvement and buy-in of the agriculture industry into TVET.	- Conducting awareness-raising actions with the agriculture industry actors on TVET and the national CoVE strategy in agriculture. - Close involvement of the agricultural industry in the design and implementation of project activities, and in governance to ensure relevance of TVET for the agriculture market.
Limited institutional capacity and coordination of TVET stakeholders among themselves as well as with sectoral stakeholders (MINAGRI, RAB, ...).	- Identification of needs and capacity building. - Facilitation of governance and coordination instances. - Involvement of key stakeholders regularly during the course of the project for ownership. - Development of MoUs with key partners outlining expected roles and responsibilities.
Low involvement and buy-in of partner institutions, such as MINAGRI and RAB, and Agri TVET Schools in the project.	- Organising awareness sessions with partner institutions and in the targeted Agri CoVEs to present the project and expectations for their participation. - Meeting with and engagement of partner institutions and targeted Agri CoVEs during project development to ensure relevance of the action and buy-in. - Further engagement of stakeholders on key project themes planned during the launch phase. Involvement of staff in decisions within their decision-making level. - Identify dedicated focal points per institution.
Low/inexistent interest of farmers, especially women, to engage in formal or flexible training.	- Awareness sessions for farmers on LLL and the benefits of engaging in a formal or flexible training. - Communication actions on success stories.

	- Meeting of centres, final beneficiaries, and private actors during the two missions, and engagement during project development to ensure relevance of the action.
Customary and social constraints preventing the project from leading to structural, institutional and behavioural changes on gender and inclusion, without which the impact of the project cannot be inclusive, sustainable and gender transformative.	- Advocacy at the level of authorities and communities. - Dedicated gender expertise within the project team. Disability and inclusion expertise will be contracted for. - Gender approach integrated into the project: activities based on a gender analysis, specific activities promoting gender equality, dialogue with partners and donors.
Disruption of social equilibrium due to a strong gender-oriented approach.	- Project will take into consideration the expectations of both women and men, and integrating them into the project guidelines. - Clear and transparent communication with both women and men regarding the activities to be conducted. - Monitoring of social equilibrium.
Delays in the infrastructure works in targeted Agri CoVEs, and in the procurement of equipment, delaying the implementation of project activities.	- Continuous support and detailed planning provided to the EF project team through contracted Assistance for infrastructure project management and Infrastructure Project Management. - Regular monitoring and supervision of infrastructure works, communication and coordination through the Infrastructure Monitoring Committee. - Selection of experienced and reliable infrastructure / equipment suppliers through EF's rigorous procurement processes. - Legal, logistics and procurement teams at Headquarters and in the Project Support Unit will support infrastructure and procurement activities. - Budget allocated for construction contingency.

7. Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning

The EF project team includes a half-time Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning (MEAL) Officer who will be responsible for developing the project's MEAL plan relying on and complementing the project's logical framework. The MEAL plan will be annualised and will unfold into specific and budgeted MEAL activities, including at least the data collection process to produce baseline and endline reports, annual reports, mid- and end-term evaluations. The MEAL Officer will also lead on the development of project specific MEAL tools for data collection and monitoring, and provide MEAL capacity-building to the EF project team and partners as necessary. RTB and other partner institutions, as well as the targeted Agri CoVE staff and CoVE Project Advisers, leading or supporting the direct implementation of activities, will play a key role in MEAL efforts. The EF HQ-based project team will support the MEAL activities through technical advice from the MEAL Coordinator and regular missions for learning, capitalisation and quality control.

The monitoring system will consider the indicators and baselines established in the inception phase, and revise when considered necessary. Each activity will be duly documented, and impact and progress criteria will be provided. EF dashboards for project management will ensure the close monitoring of activities. This monitoring will allow to identify bottlenecks and adapt interventions when necessary. Mid- and end-term evaluations of the project by independent experts will assess its overall impact, the

achievement of its goals and results, its strengths and weaknesses, and make recommendations as to its functioning and its potential continuation.

The monitoring and evaluation process will enable continuous learning to improve and adapt activities.

Regarding reporting, the system will primarily be based on the following reports:

- **Inception report:**

The inception report shall describe the findings, the progress in collecting data, the encountered and/or foreseen difficulties in addition to the work programme.

It should also include:

- a detailed work plan for the first year of implementation;
- an updated Logical Framework Matrix including baseline figures;
- a risk assessment/mitigation strategy;
- a detailed MEAL plan;
- a procedures manual.

The inception report will also provide updates on the management structure of the programme clearly describing the responsibilities of the main players as well as the decision-making process and information flow between actors. The report will be available by the end of the inception phase (month 6 from the start of the project), and adjusted/finalised with the input from the Steering Committee.

- **Annual progress reports:**

At the end of each twelve-month period, a draft progress report shall be submitted, indicating the progress achieved per indicator and include an updated workplan.

These reports will also include the state of play from the previous reporting period; actions undertaken and highlights during the reporting period; challenges and constraints encountered during the reporting period; actions required following the reporting period, including the entity responsible and the time frame; human resources mobilised, financial statement and update on any ongoing procurement. Information on the methodology of the training courses to be included in the work plan will have to be included.

The progress reports will include an updated work plan, including the activities to be undertaken within the year, assigning lead responsibilities and the budgeted costs for each activity. The work plan will be updated annually and will provide a mechanism for evaluation and review of the project on a continuous basis.

The annual report will be adjusted/finalised with the input of the Strategic Steering Committee.

- **Final report:**

The final report (narrative and financial), upon completion of the programme, shall cover the whole duration of the project and highlight the results achieved in line with the Logical Framework Matrix.

All reports should have a results-reporting orientation (including linking the specific objectives to expected results and the activities needed in order to achieve the results, against targets and baselines established in the Logical Framework).

8. Visibility and Communication

The project will follow the EU's latest visibility requirements as set out in the Communication and Visibility Manual for EU External Action.

The project will ensure that the European Union logo will appear on all products developed as part of the project together with the logos of Expertise France.

The project aligns with the priorities of the Government of Rwanda, thus representing an opportunity for the EU Delegation and EF to position their organisations as key contributors to the development of TVET

in agriculture in Rwanda, as well as to the advancement of gender equality and the empowerment of women and young girls.

Annexes

Annex 1: Indicative Logical Framework Matrix

Logical Framework Matrix

This indicative logframe constitutes the basis for the monitoring, reporting and evaluation of the intervention.

On the basis of this logframe matrix, a more detailed logframe (or several) may be developed at contracting stage. In case baselines and targets are not available for the action, they should be informed for each indicator at signature of the contract(s) linked to this AD, or in the first progress report at the latest. New columns may be added to set intermediary targets (milestones) for the Output and Outcome indicators whenever it is relevant.

- At inception, the first progress report should include the complete logframe (e.g. including baselines/targets).
- Progress reports should provide an updated logframe with current values for each indicator.
- The final report should enclose the logframe with baseline and final values for each indicator.

The indicative logical framework matrix may evolve during the lifetime of the action depending on the different implementation modalities of this action.

The activities, the expected Outputs and related indicators, targets and baselines included in the logframe matrix may be updated during the implementation of the action, no amendment being required to the Financing Decision.

PROJECT MODALITY (3 levels of results / indicators / Source of Data / Assumptions - no activities)

Results	Results chain (@): Main expected results (maximum 10)	Indicators (@): (at least one indicator per expected result)	Baselines (values and years)	Targets (values and years)	Sources of data	Assumptions
Impact	The Overall Objective of this action is to contribute to increased sustainability, climate resilience and inclusivity of agriculture practices by strengthening skills of women and youth including persons with disability, in Rwanda.	1. Percentage of farmers adopting climate-resilient crop varieties, disaggregated by sex.	1. Value: 37.1% (season A), 20.8% (season B), and 20.7% (season C) used improved seeds (2023).	1. Value: 50% (2025), 90% (2030).	1. Agriculture Household Surveys, National Institute of Statistics Rwanda (NISR)	Not applicable
		2. Percentage of qualified labour-force (minimal level of qualification level 1) in the agriculture sector, disaggregated by sex.	2. Value: 14.2% - TBC (2023).	2. Value: TBD in the inception phase (2029).	2. Agriculture Household Surveys, MIFOTRA, MINAGRI annual reports.	
Outcome 1	1. Improve access of women and youth (including persons with disability) to quality skills set and formal certification in agricultural practices, including climate-resilient agricultural practices.	1.1. Number of TVET students enrolled in agriculture-related trades, disaggregated by sex (national level).	1.1. Value: total 7.089, of which 2.837 male (40%) and 4.252 female (60%) (2023)	1.1. Value: total 10.630 (+50%), of which 3.190 (30%) male and 7.440 female (70%) (2029).	1.1. RTB annual reports.	The Rwandan government continues to provide a conducive framework for agricultural transformation. Interest of farmers, especially women, and youth in training in the agriculture sector. Involvement and availability of staff from the agriculture TVET centres.
		1.2. Number of people (farmers and students) who have benefited from workplace based VET/skills development interventions supported by the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by sex. (Global Europe Results Framework 2.14a)	1.2. Value: 0 (2024).	1.2. Value: 1.200 farmers and 900 students (2029).	1.2. MINEDUC / RTB reports / project reports.	
		1.3. Percentage of Agri TVET Centres that declare applying the training materials and frameworks for vocational excellency in agriculture	1.3. Value: N/A (2024).	1.3. Value: 70% (2029).	1.3. RTB reports / Project survey.	

		developed by the EU-funded intervention.				
		1.4. Completion rate of students from Agri TVET Centres and CoVEs, disaggregated by trade and sex.	1.4. Value: TBC (2024).	1.4. Value: TBD in the inception phase (2029).	1.4. NESA and MINEDUC / RTB annual reports.	
		1.5. Percentage of farmers trained by the EU-funded intervention who declare that they apply the climate-resilient practices taught through Agri CoVEs, disaggregated by sex.	1.5. Value: NA (2024).	1.5. Value: 70% (2029).	1.5. Project survey for farmers.	
Outcome 2	2. Enhance the effectiveness of mechanisms for the integration of women and youth (including persons with disability) on the agriculture labour market, with a focus on climate-resilient and sustainable farming.	2.1. Percentage of students from targeted Agri CoVEs that declare being employed 6 months after training completion, disaggregated by type (green/non-green, paid/unpaid) and sex.	2.1. Value: NA (2024).	2.1. Value: 50% (2029).	2.1. Project survey for students.	Interest of farmers, especially women, and youth in employment in the agriculture sector.
		2.2. Number of jobs supported / sustained by the EU, disaggregated by green vs non-green jobs (Global Europe Results Framework 2.13)	2.2. Value: 0 (2024).	2.2. Value: TBD in the inception phase (2029).	2.2. Project survey for students and farmers.	
Output 1 relating to Outcome 1	1.1. Enhanced capacity of TVET institutions and the agriculture industry actors to address skills and employment needs,	1.1.1. Number of skills-needs analyses in agriculture focused on green skills and skills tailored to the needs of women and persons with disability, developed with support of the EU-funded intervention.	1.1.1. Value: 0 (2024).	1.1.1. Value: 3 (2029).	1.1.1. SSC reports / project reports.	Active involvement of the SSC, PSF, agriculture industry actors, MIGEPROF/GMO.

	emphasising climate-resilient practices and the specific skill requirements of women and persons with disability.	1.1.2. Number of staff from TVET institutions and agriculture industry actors that participate in awareness-raising and/or capacity-building events organised by the EU-funded intervention on the specific needs of women and persons with disability in the agricultural sector.	1.1.2. Value: 0 (2024).	1.1.2. Value: TBD in the inception phase (2029).	1.1.2. SSC reports / MIGEPROF / GMO reports / project reports (attendance sheet).	
Output 2 relating to Outcome 1	1.2. Enhanced capacity of national Agri TVET Schools to provide standardised quality training in agriculture that is relevant to labour market needs and climate action, and is gender-responsive.	1.2.1. Number of guiding documents for sustainable Agri CoVEs developed with support of the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by type (governance model, production unit business model, trainers' guide)	1.2.1. Value: 0 (2024).	1.2.1. Value: 3 (2029).	1.2.1. NESA annual reports / RTB annual reports / project reports.	Involvement of NESA, RTB, PSF, agriculture industry actors, and gender and inclusion actors. Staff in charge of training and evaluation frameworks is available and committed to participate in the training.
		1.2.2. Number of certification and evaluation frameworks for vocational excellency in agriculture* developed/revised with support of the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by type (certification framework, evaluation guidelines, Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) framework) <i>*Vocational excellency in agriculture defined as taking into account climate-resilience, gender and inclusion</i>	1.2.2. Value: 0 (2024).	1.2.2. Value: 3 (2029).	1.2.2. NESA annual reports / RTB annual reports / project reports.	
		1.2.3. Number of training programmes co-designed with agriculture industry actors to take into account labour market needs, climate action, and gender.	1.2.3. Value: 0 (2024).	1.2.3. Value: 3 (2029).	1.2.3. RTB annual reports/project reports.	

		1.2.4. Percentage of staff in charge of training and evaluation frameworks, including RPL evaluators, having received capacity-building on the new vocational excellency documents developed with support of the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by sex.	1.2.4. Value: 0 (2024).	1.2.4. Value: 60% (2029).	1.2.4. NESA annual reports / RTB annual reports / project reports (attendance sheet).	
Output 3 relating to Outcome 1	1.3. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to provide quality training and a conducive learning environment.	1.3.1. Number of Agri CoVEs equipped with material resources (equipment and infrastructure) that are gender-responsive and inclusive, through the EU-funded intervention.	1.3.1. Value: 0 (2024).	1.3.1. Value: 3 (2029).	1.3.1. RTB, targeted Agri CoVEs' lists of infrastructure and equipment / project reports.	Involvement of RTB, and targeted Agri CoVEs' staff.
		1.3.2. Number of targeted Agri CoVEs' staff members having received training on gender, climate action and/or labour-market exposure, disaggregated by staff type (management staff, administrative staff, teaching staff) and by sex.	1.3.2. Value: 0 (2024).	1.3.2. Value: 132 (2029).	1.3.2. RTB, targeted Agri CoVEs reports / project reports (attendance sheet).	Required conditions are met to conduct infrastructure work (climate, safety, permits, etc.).
		1.3.3. Number of production units and resource centres set up in Agri CoVEs with support from the EU-funded intervention.	1.3.3. Value: 0 (2024).	1.3.3. Value: 6 (2029).	1.3.3. RTB, targeted Agri CoVEs' annual reports / project reports.	Equipment is available for purchase.

Output 4 relating to Outcome 1	1.4. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to link with their ecosystem (research institutions, other TVET Schools, private sector, communities).	1.4.1. Number of staff from Agri TVET Schools and institutions that attended at least one exchange meeting led by targeted Agri CoVEs, disaggregated by type (pedagogy, production unit management, enterprise and research cooperation).	1.4.1. Value: 0 (2024).	1.4.1. Value: TBD in the inception phase (2029).	1.4.1. Targeted Agri CoVEs annual reports / project reports (attendance sheet).	Interest and involvement of Agri TVE Centres and institutions, of agricultural research actors such as RAB, and the private sector.
		1.4.2. Number of partnerships established between targeted Agri CoVEs and the private sector and/or research institutions, developed with support of the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by type of stakeholder (private/research institution)	1.4.2. Value: 0 (2024).	1.4.2. Value: 6 (2029).	1.4.2. Targeted Agri CoVEs annual reports / project reports.	Involvement of Agri CoVEs' staff. Interest and involvement of farmers, especially women, from neighbouring communities to engage in joint activities with targeted Agri CoVEs.
		1.4.3. Number of engagement activities and environmental projects carried out by targeted Agri CoVEs with the communities, supported by the EU-funded intervention.	1.4.3. Value: 0 (2024).	1.4.3. Value: TBD in the inception phase (2029).	1.4.3. Targeted Agri CoVEs annual reports / project reports.	
Output 5 relating to Outcome 1	1.5. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to provide quality training and certification to farmers, especially women.	1.5.1. Number of farmers having received the mobile and/or digital training programme, aimed to improve their sustainable agricultural practices, disaggregated by sex and age.	1.5.1. Value: 0 (2024).	1.5.1. Value: 1,200 farmers, of which 70% women (2029).	1.5.1. RAB annual reports / Targeted Agri CoVEs annual reports / project reports (attendance sheet).	Involvement of RAB and their Farmers Field Schools extension officers. Interest expressed by of farmers,

		1.5.2. Percentage of farmers trained by the EU-funded intervention that reach level X [to be determined in the inception period] on the pre/post-test, disaggregated by sex and age.	1.5.2. Value: NA (2024).	1.5.2. Value: 70% (2029).	1.5.2. Pre- and post-training test reports.	especially women, for training, for certifying their skills through RPL, and for transferring skills to their peers.
		1.5.3. Number of farmers certified through the Recognition of Prior-Learning (RPL) in agriculture developed with support from the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by sex and age.	1.5.3. Value: NA (2024).	1.5.3. Value: TBD in the inception phase (2029).	1.5.3. RAB annual reports / RTB annual reports / targeted Agri CoVEs reports / project reports.	
		1.5.4. Number of Master Trainer farmers trained, with the support of the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by sex and age.	1.5.4. Value: 0 (2024).	1.5.4. Value: 120, of which 70% women (2029).	1.5.4 RAB annual reports / targeted Agri CoVEs annual reports / project reports (attendance sheet).	
Output 1 relating to Outcome 2	2.1. Enhanced capacity of Agri TVET Schools at national level to deliver standardised quality career guidance and market opportunity linkages.	2.1.1. Number of guiding documents for quality career guidance in agriculture, developed with support of the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by type (enterprise cooperation model, work-based learning guidelines, school guidance framework)	2.1.1. Value: 0 (2024).	2.1.1. Value: 3 (2029).	2.1.1. NESA annual reports / RTB annual reports / Project reports.	Involvement of NESA, RTB and the agriculture industry actors.

		2.1.2. Number of modular short courses programmes revised/developed with the support of the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by topic (soft skills, entrepreneurship, leadership, cooperative management).	2.1.2. Value: 0 (2024).	2.1.2. Value: 4 (2029).	2.1.2. RTB annual reports / project reports.	
Output 2 relating to Outcome 2	2.2. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to deliver quality career and transition to work guidance.	2.2.1. Number of Agri CoVE staff trained to run the career guidance and market integration unit, put in place with support from the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by sex.	2.2.1. Value: 0 (2024).	2.2.1. Value: 6 (2029).	2.2.1. Targeted Agri CoVEs annual reports / project reports (attendance sheet).	Involvement of RTB and targeted Agri CoVEs staff.
Output 3 relating to Outcome 2	2.3. Enhanced capacity of targeted Agri CoVEs to support linkages to market/productive opportunities.	2.3.1. Percentage of students from targeted Agri CoVEs participating in the internship and mentorship programme, developed with support from the EU-funded intervention, disaggregated by sex.	2.3.1. Value: NA (2024).	2.3.1. Value: 70 % (2029).	2.3.1. Targeted Agri CoVEs annual reports / project reports.	Involvement of agriculture industry actors and cooperatives, and targeted Agri CoVEs staff. Interest of students in internship and mentorship opportunities.
		2.3.2. Percentage of farmers trained by the EU-funded intervention linked with cooperatives and/or agriculture industry actor, disaggregated by sex and age.	2.3.2. Value: NA (2024).	2.3.2. Value: 60% (2029).	2.3.2. Registers of cooperatives / project reports.	Interest of farmers, especially women, to engage with cooperatives and agriculture industry actors.

Annex 2: Indicative Work Plan for year 1 and 2

Annex 3: Indicative Budget